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Test – 17

Art & Culture

Topics covered:

- Indian Art & Architecture
- Indian Paintings & Dance Forms
- Indian Music
- Indian Puppetry
- Indian Literature, Fairs & Festivals
- Indian Theatre and miscellaneous
- Current Affairs January to June 2021



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DEDICATED PRELIM PROGRAM(DPP)

UPSC-CSE PRELIMINARY TEST SERIES – 2021/2022

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TEST BOOKLET SERIES

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GENERAL STUDIES
TEST -17

E17

Time Allowed: Two Hours

Maximum Marks : 200

INSTRUCTIONS

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TOPICS COVERD: Indian Art & Architecture, Indian Paintings & Dance Forms, Indian Music & Indian Puppetry
Indian Literature, Fairs & Festivals, Indian Theatre and miscellaneous, Current Affairs January to June 2021



Q.1) With reference to Nagara Temple Architecture, which of the following statements is/are correct ?

1. The temples are usually built on a stone platform with elaborate boundary walls or gateways
2. The *garbhagriha* is always located directly under the tallest tower.
3. The pyramidal spire over the *garbhagriha* is called *Amalaka*.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1,2 and 3
- d) None of the above

Q.2) With reference to Mauryan Architecture, consider the following statements:

1. The shafts of the Ashokan Pillars were monolithic in nature and were primarily made of Chunar Sandstone.
2. Unlike the Ashokan pillars, the Persian columns of Achaemenid Persia were individual free-standing monuments.
3. The Pillars were widely used to propagate *Dhamma*.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.3) Which of the following edicts describes Emperor Ashoka's visit to the birthplace of Lord Buddha?

- a) Maski
- b) Sannati
- c) Rumminidei
- d) Kalsi

Q.4) Consider the following pairs:

Islamic Monument Built by/under

1. Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque- Qutb-ud-din Aibak
2. Gol Gumbaz of Bijapur- Muhammad Adil Shah
3. Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra- Allaudin Khilji

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.5) Which of the following Monuments of medieval India was built earliest?

- a) Bara Imambara

- b) Rumi Darwaza
- c) Alai Darwaza
- d) Tughlaqabad Fort

Q.6) With reference to Hoysala temple Architecture, consider the following statements:

1. This style of architecture flourished between the 4th and 5th Century AD when the Hoysala influence was at its peak.
2. These temples were constructed in the Vesara Style of Architecture and are known for their stellate or star-like pattern.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.7) "These Jain temples are one of the most famous celebrated works of the Māru-Gurjara Architecture. They are famous for their use of a very pure white marble and intricate marble carvings. There are various temples dedicated to Lord Rishabha and Lord Parshvanath"

Which of the following temple complexes has been described above?

- a) Palitana Temples
- b) Dilwara Temples
- c) Shikharji Temples
- d) Pandrethan Temples

Q.8) Which of the following temples are examples of Rock-Cut Architecture ?

1. Shore temple at Mahabalipuram
2. Ladkhan temple of Aihole
3. Kailash Temple of Ellora
4. Rani ki Vav at Patan

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 and 4 only
- c) 1,2 and 4 only
- d) 1,3 and 4 only

Q.9) Which of the following temples finds mention in Sanskrit Historian Kalhana's *Rajatarangini* ?

- a) Nachna Kuthara Temple
- b) Pandrethan Temple
- c) Dashavatara Temple
- d) Lepakshi Temple

Q.10) Consider the following Pairs:



Temple

1. Chaturbhuja Temple
2. Omkareshwar Temple
3. Konark Sun Temple

River

1. Betwa
2. Tapi
3. Mahanadi

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.11) Consider the following statements:

1. The Lomas Rishi Cave is one of the many man-made caves present at the Elephanta group of caves.
2. The Bagh Caves are renowned for their rock cut architecture and splendid Mural paintings.
3. The caves at Badami are predominantly Buddhist.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.12) In the context of Medieval art and culture, which of the following phrases describes "Parchin kari" ?

- a) Songs sung by Sufi Mystics
- b) Decorational element in Indo-Islamic Architecture
- c) Writing style adopted by Historians of Mughal Court
- d) A form of embroidery during the Mughal Era

Q.13) With reference to the Gomateswara statue at Shravanabelagola, consider the following statements:

1. It is the tallest monolithic statue in the world, carved out of a single block of Basaltic rock.
2. It was commissioned by Chavundaraya, the minister and commander of the Ganga Dynasty.
3. It is dedicated to Bahubali, the son of the last tirthankara of Jainism.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.14) "At this place, there is a masterly representation of an elephant depicted as if emerging from a rock which has been so cut that it resembles the front part of an elephant including the head and

trunk. It is interesting as almost the first attempt at carving a colossal animal figure out of a rock or a boulder."

The place described in the above excerpt is:

- a) Barabar Caves, Bihar
- b) Dhuli, Odisha
- c) Karle Caves, Maharashtra
- d) Sanchi Stupa, Madhya Pradesh

Q.15) The terms Valabhi, Rekha-prasad, Phamsana are associated with:

- a) Three types of temple architecture found in India
- b) Three types of musical instruments played in Sattriya dance form
- c) Three types of gateways in Gupta architecture
- d) Three types of shikhara styles in Nagara temple architecture

Q.16) Which of the following temples belong to the Odisha school of temple architecture?

1. Sun Temple at Konark
2. Kandariya Mahadeva Temple
3. Lingaraja Temple
4. Jagannath Temple

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, and 4 only
- d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Q.17) "The temples are surrounded by high boundary walls. The crowning element is shaped in the form of an octagon and is known as shikhara. The entrance of the garbhagriha had sculptures of Dwaarpal, mithun and yaksha. Water tank inside the temple is a unique feature of this style."

Which temple architecture style/school has been described in the above paragraph?

- a) Maru- Gurjara school
- b) Vesara school
- c) Dravid school
- d) Nagara school

Q.18) Consider the following statement about the pahari style of painting.



1. Kangra school painting flourished in sub-Himalayan states even before the establishment of Mughal empire.
2. Basohli school is a painting of pahari style.
3. Gita Govinda, Bhagavata purana and satsai are among the several famous subjects of this style of painting.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.19) Which of the following historical places are known for prehistoric rock paintings ?

1. Jogimara caves
2. Bhimbetka caves
3. Narsingharh

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.20) The painting of 'Bodhisattva Vajrapani' is one of the most famous and oft-illustrated paintings at -

- a) Elephanta Caves
- b) Ajanta Caves
- c) Ellora Caves
- d) Bagh Caves

Q.21) Consider the following pairs:

Folk Dance	State
1. Luddi dance	- Punjab
2. Thang ta	- Manipur
3. Mosak Sumani	- Tripura
4. Purulia Chhau	- Assam

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 4 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.22) With reference to kalbelia dance of India, Consider the following statement.

1. It is a UNESCO Intangible heritage sensual dance form performed by Kalbelia tribes from Rajasthan.

2. In Kalbelia dance, Men perform the swirls replicating the movement of snakes while dancing. whereas women play no role in Kalbelia.
3. Kalbelia tribes use only pungi (Been) as musical instruments.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.23) Consider the following statement about sattriya dance form of India:

1. Sattriya dance originated by Vaishnavite saint Sankardeva in Assam.
2. One act play is called Ankiya Nat which combines ballad, dance and drama with religious and aesthetic themes.
3. It emphasizes on devotional aspects and narrates myths of Shiva and Paravati.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2
- c) 1 and 3
- d) 2 and 3

Q.24) Alarippu, Jatiswaram, Shabdham, Varnam - terms associated with which of the following dance forms ?

- a) Kuchipudi
- b) Mohiniattam
- c) Bharatnatyam
- d) Odissi

Q.25) Consider the following statements with respect to classical dance forms of India:

1. At present, there are 8 classical dance forms recognised by Sangeet Natak Akademi and the Ministry of Culture.
2. ' Fire Dance ' is another name of Sattriya dance form.
3. Mangalacharan is the opening ritual of Odissi dance form.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3



Q.26) Match the following lists with reference to the folk dances and the related region.

<u>Folk Dance</u>	<u>Region</u>
1. Tarangamel	A) Uttar Pradesh
2. Dadra	B) Goa
3. Jawara	C) Madhya Pradesh
4. Gaur Maria	D) West Bengal
5. Alkap	E) Chhattisgarh

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- a) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D, 5-E
- b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-E, 5-D
- c) 1-C, 2-E, 3-A, 4-B, 5-D
- d) 1-D, 2-B, 3-A, 4-C, 5-E

Q.27) Which of the following statements is incorrect with respect to Kathak dance form?

- a) Jugalbandi, a competitive play between dancer and tabla player is the main attraction of this type of dance form.
- b) Naga Bandha mudra (body connected through curves in shape of 8) is an important component of Kathak dance form.
- c) Kathak dance is generally accompanied with dhrupad music.
- d) Kathak dance form was influenced by Persian costumes and style of dancing.

Q.28) Consider the following pairs of Indian dance forms and prominent musical instruments associated with them:

- 1. Kalbelia: Been
- 2. Manipuri: Pung
- 3. Kuchipudi: Mridangam

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.29) Consider the following pairs of Indian dance forms and prominent postures associated with them:

- 1. Odissi: Tribhanga
- 2. Kathak: Nagabandha Mudra
- 3. Kuchipudi: Tarangam

Which of the pair(s) given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.30) Consider the following statements with reference to the classical dances in India:

- 1. The Lasya aspect of dance is dominant in a Mohiniyattam recital.
- 2. Odissi and Kathak both are generally accompanied with Carnatic music.
- 3. Kuchipudi dance is generally accompanied by Hindustani classical music.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.31) "It is the oldest among all classical dance forms. Its origin can be traced back to the solo dance performances of the temple dancers or 'devadasis' in the southern region of the country. In this dance form, equal emphasis is given on both the Tandava and Lasya aspects of dance, with major emphasis on 'mudras. 'Alarippu', 'Jatiswaram', 'Shabdam' are some of the major elements of this dance."

Which one of the following Indian classical dances has been described in the above paragraph?

- a) Kuchipudi Dance
- b) Bharatnatyam Dance
- c) Mohiniattam
- d) Kathak

Q.32) Consider the following pairs:

<u>Folk Music</u>	<u>states</u>
1. Khongjom Parba	- Assam
2. Mand	- Rajasthan
3. Ovi	- Gujarat

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct ?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.33) Consider the following statements about Amir Khusro:

- 1. He is credited with the origin of Qawwali, Khayal, Tarana and Thumri



2. He also invented the musical instrument Sehtar and enriched Indian classical music by introducing Persian and Arabic elements in it.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.34) With reference to cultural history of India, consider the following statements:

- 1. Purandar Dasa is widely referred to as "Pitamaha or father/grandfather of Carnatic Music"
- 2. Purandar Dasa was a contemporary of Annamacharya, who is also known as the first composer of Carnatic music.
- 3. Purandar Dasa composed sankeertanas in praise of Lord Venkateswara.
- 4. Annamacharya composed the famous composition Dasa Sahithya.

Select the correct answer by using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3 only

Q.35) The terms Pallavi, Charana, Anu-Pallavi are associated with -

- a) Parts of Carnatic style composition
- b) Limbs/principles of Vachakabhinaya
- c) Ragas in Hindustani classical music
- d) Parts of Indian Classical Dance- Bharatnatyam

Q.36) Consider the following statement about forms of Indian Puppetry:

- 1. Gombeyatta is a String puppet show from the Indian state of Tamilnadu.
- 2. The Gombeyatta puppet show is a parallel tradition of Yakshagana, a classical dance drama.
- 3. More than one puppeteer is used to manipulate the puppets in Gombeyatta puppetry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 2 and 3 only

Q.37) Consider the following pairs:

Puppetry	Specification
----------	---------------

- | | | |
|----------------|---|--------------------------------|
| 1. Pavakoothu | - | Glove puppetry from kerala |
| 2. Putul Nach | - | String Puppetry from Bihar |
| 3. Ravanchayya | - | Shadow Puppetry from Odisha |
| 4. Kundhei | - | String Puppetry from Tamilnadu |

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.38) With reference to the origin of puppetry, consider the following statements:

- 1. The earliest reference of puppetry in India is found in the book named Natyashastra.
- 2. The earliest evidence of puppetry in India is found in the Indus Valley Civilization.

Which of the above given statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.39) With reference to traditional puppetry in India, consider the following pairs:

- | Puppetry | state |
|--------------------|--------------|
| 1. Kathputli | - Rajasthan |
| 2. Kundhei | - Odisha |
| 3. Gombeyatta | - Tamil Nadu |
| 4. Bommalattam | - Karnataka |
| 5. Tholu Bommalata | - Kerala |
| 6. Yampuri | : Bihar |

Which of the above given pairs is/are correct ?

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 6 only
- b) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- c) 1, 2 and 6 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6

Q.40) Consider the following statements related to a type of puppetry prevalent in India:

- 1. Puppets are carved from wood and are 3-4 feet in height.
- 2. One of its sub forms resembles the Bunraku puppets of Japan.
- 3. Mostly accompanied by 3-4 musicians playing harmonium, cymbals and tabla.



Which of the following puppetry forms is mentioned here?

- a) Yampuri
- b) Putul Nach
- c) Pavakoothu
- d) Ravana Chhaya

Q.41) The musical instruments, Chenda, Chengilola, Ilathalam and Shankha (conch), are used in which type of puppetry in India?

- a) Pavakoothu
- b) Togalu Gombeyaata
- c) Ravan Chayya
- d) Bommalattam

Q.42) Which of the following puppetry have features of both rod and string puppetry ?

- a) Bommalattam
- b) Gombeyatta
- c) Putul Nach
- d) Yampuri

Q.43) Which of the following statements is incorrect about Ravan Chaya puppetry?

- a) In this type, usage of deer skin is prevalent in making of the puppets.
- b) Ravan Chaya is considered as the most advanced form of theatrical puppetry
- c) In Ravan Chaya puppetry there is presence of non-human puppets as various props during the puppetry show.
- d) Ravan Chaya puppets are the largest and heaviest of all puppets made in India.

Q.44) Which among the following is not a type of 'Shadow puppetry'?

- a) Tholpavakoothu
- b) Charma Bahuli Natya
- c) Gombeyatta
- d) Tholu Bommalata

Q.45) In the context of the Jain religious texts, Which of the following statements is/are Incorrect?

- 1. *Agamas* are considered sacred texts by both *Digambaras* and *Svetambaras*.
- 2. The compilation of *Agamas* was done at the Vallabhi council of Jainism.
- 3. The Jain texts contain works of Gujarati and Marathi but are devoid of Kannada.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.46) Consider the following pairs:

Literature	Feature
1. <i>Avesta</i>	<i>Aham/Puram</i>
2. <i>Sangam</i>	<i>Yasna</i>
3. <i>Yajur Veda</i>	<i>Shatapatha Brahmana</i>
4. <i>Adi Purana</i>	<i>Champu</i>

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.47) With reference to the Indian literature, which of the statements given below is/are incorrect?

- 1. *Vande Mataram*, the national song, is a part of *Anandamath*.
- 2. *Dingal* and *Pingal* are associated with Gujarati literature.
- 3. Saint Jnaneshwar has been associated with the practice of *Kirtan*.
- 4. The dominance of *Dogri* in Kashmir was prominent from ancient times.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 4 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 4 only
- d) 3 and 4 only

Q.48) With reference to the literature of ancient India, Consider the following pairs:

Literature	Author
1. <i>Gita Govinda</i>	- Jaydeva
2. <i>Buddhacarita</i>	- Amarasimha.
3. <i>Malavikagnimitram</i>	- Kalidasa.
4. <i>Harshacharita</i>	- Harshavardhana.

Which of the pairs given above is/are incorrectly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 4 only



d) 1 and 3 only

Q.49) Consider the following pairs:

Festival/Fair		State
1. Kharchi Puja	-	Tripura
2. Wangala Festival	-	Manipur
3. Rongkhli	-	Meghalaya
4. Losar festival	-	Arunachal Pradesh

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 4 only
- c) 1, 2 and 4 only
- d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Q.50) In the context of the Nabakalebar festival, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. It is an annual festival associated with the Jagannath Temple in Puri.
- 2. The prime attraction of the festival is the special sacred logs of pipal trees.
- 3. It is accompanied by the Chariot festival or the Rath Yatra celebrated in Puri.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.51) Consider the following pairs:

Festival		Feature
1. Eid-ul-Zuha	-	Sacrifice of Goat
2. Muharram	-	First Month of Islamic Calendar
3. Shab-e-Barat	-	Sunni Muslims

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.52) In the context of Sikh festivals of India, which of the statements given below is least appropriate?

- a) Maghi is celebrated to commemorate the Sikh Martyrs of Sikh-Muslim war.
- b) Parkash Utsav Dasveh Patshah is celebrated to mark the birth anniversary of all the Sikh gurus.
- c) The festival of Baisakhi commemorates the birth of the Khalsa Panth in Sikhism.

d) Lohri is the festival of fertility and light celebrated in the Hindu month of Magh.

Q.53) Consider the following statements regarding the festivals of India:

- 1. *Cheti Chand* is celebrated as the Sindhi New Year in the month of *Chaitra*.
- 2. Mask dance forms an important part of *Hemis Gompa*, a Jain festival.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.54) Consider the following pairs:

Festival		State
1. Dree	-	Arunachal Pradesh
2. Moatsu Mong	-	Nagaland
3. Kang Chingba	-	Mizoram
4. Khan	-	Arunachal Pradesh

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1, 3, and 4 only
- b) 1, 2, and 3 only
- c) 2, 3, and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, and 4 only

Q.55) In the context of Kumbha Mela, which of the statements given below is/are incorrect?

- 1. *Ardh-Kumbha Mela* is organized every six years in four cities of India.
- 2. *Simhastha Kumbha* is associated with the rivers Godavari and Shipra.
- 3. It is the only tradition added to UNESCO's list of Intangible Heritage from Uttar Pradesh.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.56) Consider the following statements regarding the fairs of India:

- 1. Both *Pushkar* and *Sonepur* fairs are associated with the sale and purchase of cattle.
- 2. *Shamlaji* and the *Kolayat* Fair are associated with the *Bhil* tribes of Rajasthan.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only



- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.57) Which of the following festival(s) given below are associated with the state of Assam?

- 1. Maagh Bihu
- 2. Bohag Bihu
- 3. Kati Bihu
- 4. Kongali Bihu

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Q.58) Consider the following statements:

- 1. *Vallam Kali* and *Onakanikal* is a prominent feature observed in *Onam*.
- 2. *Sair-e-Gul Faroshan* is a festival associated with the Yogmaya Temple of Delhi.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.59) Consider the following statements:

- 1. While *Deepavali* is celebrated on the New Moon Day, *Dev Deepavali* is celebrated on the day of Full Moon.
- 2. *Dev Deepavali* is restricted to a single state while *Deepavali* is celebrated across various states of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.60) Consider the following pairs of toys produced in India and their traditional centres of production:

Toys	Production centre
1. Channapatna toys	Karnataka
2. Kondapalli toys	Kerala
3. Kinhal toys	West Bengal

Which of the above pair(s) is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only

- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.61) Consider the following statements with reference to Samkhya philosophical school:

- 1. This is the oldest school of philosophy founded by Kapil Muni and believed in dualism.
- 2. The school gives importance to acquisition of knowledge for attainment of salvation.
- 3. The philosophy argues that Prakriti and Purusha are absolute and independent.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.62) Consider the following statements with reference to Vaisheshika and Charvaka school of philosophy:

- 1. While Vaisheshika school considers fire, air, water, earth and ether (sky) as the essential elements of the universe, Charvaka school does not consider ether as an essential element.
- 2. Vaisheshika school argued for scientific thinking and like Charvaka school did not believe in god.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.63) Consider the following statements with reference to Yoga school of philosophy and Nyaya school of philosophy:

- 1. The Yoga school is believed to be founded by Patanjali and the Nyaya school by Kanada.
- 2. According to Yoga school salvation can be achieved by combining meditation and physical application of yogic postures, whereas according to Nyaya school, it can be achieved by logical thinking.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.64) Consider the following statements with reference to Mimamsa school of philosophy and Vedanta school of philosophy:



1. While the Mimamsa school derives its origin from the work of Badarayana, the Vedanta school derives from the work of Jaimini.

2. While the Mimamsa school is based on the Samhita and Brahmana portions of Vedas, the Vedanta school is based on the Upanishads.

3. While the Mimamsa school argued that salvation is possible through performing rituals, the Vedanta school argued for knowledge of the self to achieve salvation.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.65) Consider the following statements about the Koodiyattam theatre that has been included into UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage:

1. It is a combined dance drama from Karnataka based on Hindu mythology.

2. The male and female roles in the drama are traditionally played by the people from Chakyar caste.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.66) Consider the following pairs of cultural heritage included into the UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage and the region in which they are performed:

Cultural heritage	Region
1. Ramman	- Himachal Pradesh
2. Mudi yettu	- Kerala
3. Kalbelia	- Rajasthan

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.67) Consider the following statements with reference to Chhau Dance:

1. The dance is mainly performed in Odisha, Jharkhand and West Bengal and is included in the UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage.

2. The dancers wear masks during performances except in Mayurbhanj Chhau.

3. The masks of Purulia Chhau and Saraikella Chhau have been given a Geographical Indication tag.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.68) Consider the following statements about Sankirtana that has been included in the UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage:

1. It is a ritual singing, drumming and dancing art form of Assam which originated in the 15th century AD.

2. It is a celebration of various stages of Vaishnavites here and narrates the life and deeds of Lord Krishna.

Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.69) Consider the following statements with reference to sects of Vaishnavism:

1. The Varkari sect is centred at Pandharpur in Maharashtra with Jnaneshwar, Namdev being prominent figures of the sect.

2. Brahma Sampradaya was founded by Madhvacharya and ISKCON belongs to this group.

3. Pushti Marg sampradaya was founded by Vallabhacharya and based on pure love for Lord Ram.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.70) Consider the following statements with reference to sects of Shaivism:

1. Nathpanthis follow the teachings of Gorakhnath and worship the Adinath form of Shiva.

2. Dashnami Sannyasis are the disciples of Adi Shankaracharya and are associated with the Advaita Vedanta.

3. Aghoris are devotees of the Bhairava form of Shiva and indulge in extreme, tamasic ritual practices.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3



Q.71) Which of the following statements with reference to the All-India Survey on Higher Education, 2019-20 is correct?

- a) The Gross Enrolment Ratio of students in the eligible age group (18-23 years) is more than 31% in 2019-20.
- b) The Gender Parity Index shows better access to higher education for females compared to males.
- c) The pupil-teacher ratio in higher education is below 20.
- d) There has been more than 10% growth in total enrolment in higher education between 2014-15 and 2019-20.

Q.72) Consider following statements regarding Pangolin :

- 1. Pangolin is listed in schedule I of Wildlife Protection Act , 1972.
- 2. Indian Pangolin is Endangered species under IUCN status.
- 3. Chinese Pangolins are not found in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.73) Consider the following statements with reference to the recently in news INS Sandhayak :

- 1. INS Sandhayak was the first of its class indigenously designed and built Hydrographic Survey Ship of the Indian Navy.
- 2. It was developed by the Cochin Shipyard Limited, Kochi.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.74) "State of India's Environment 2021" report is released by -

- a) NITI Aayog
- b) Minister of Environment Forest and Climate Change
- c) Centre for Science and Environment.
- d) Forest Research Institute of India.

Q.75) Consider the following statements with respect to the CHIME telescope.

- 1. It is a large stationary radio telescope located in British Columbia, Canada.
- 2. The telescope's first Fast Radio Burst(FRB) catalogue was recently published in collaboration with Indian Institute of Astrophysics, Bengaluru.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.76) Which of the following statements is correct with respect to " Performance Grading Index" - 2019-2020?

- a) The Ministry of Education has released first ever the Performance Grading Index (PGI) 2019- 2020.
- b) No state had reached Level 1 and Grade 1++ in " Performance Grading Index" - 2019- 2020.
- c) Kerala recorded the highest score topped the charts in terms of equity, infrastructure and governance.
- d) The Union Territory of Ladakh was included separately for the first time in this edition, and had the lowest score in the index.

Q.77) Consider the following statements with regard to the Atal Tinkering Laboratories(ATLs):

- 1. It is an initiative by the Atal Innovation Mission, an initiative of Niti Aayog to foster curiosity, creativity and imagination in young minds.
- 2. Young children will get a chance to work with tools and equipment to understand the concepts of STEM - Science, Technology, Engineering and Maths.
- 3. Atal Innovation Mission will provide grant-in-aid of Rs. 50 Lakh to each school to set up Atal Tinkering Laboratories

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.78) Consider the following statements with reference to the Arctic Region :

- 1. The Arctic consists of the Arctic Ocean, adjacent seas, and parts of Alaska (United States), Canada, Finland, Greenland (Denmark), Iceland, Norway, Russia, and Sweden.
- 2. IndArc, India's first multi-sensor moored observatory was deployed in Kongsfjorden.
- 3. India is a member of Arctic council



Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.79) Consider the following statements with reference to the Open Skies Treaty:

- 1. It aims to build confidence among members through mutual openness thus reducing the chances of accidental war.
- 2. Under the treaty, a member state cannot spy on any part of the host nation, with the latter's consent
- 3. India is a member of this treaty

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1 and 3

Q.80) With reference to the 4th edition of One Planet Summit, which of the following statements is/are correct ?

- 1. It is dedicated to biodiversity aiming to raise the level of ambition of the international community on nature protection
- 2. Denmark organized the summit in cooperation with the United Nations and the World Bank.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.81) Consider the following statements :

- 1. There is no limit on the number of star campaigners for a recognized political party.
- 2. Expenditure of star campaigners is exempted from being added to the election expenditure of a candidate.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.82) Which of the following describes best the concept of K- Shaped recovery?

- a) The economy falls quickly but also recovers quickly—it doesn't remain stagnant for very long.

b) It occurs when different sections of an economy recover at starkly different rates.

c) It involves a short recovery followed by another decline before the economy goes into a more long-term recovery.

d) The economy declines quickly but then remains stagnant for a long period.

Q.83) Which of the following statements is/are not correct about the Payments Infrastructure Development Fund (PIDF) Scheme ?

- 1. Its objective is to develop payment acceptance infrastructure in tier-3 to tier-6 cities (centres), with a special focus on the north-eastern states of the country.
- 2. Payments Infrastructure Development Fund shall be governed by the Ministry of Finance.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.84) Consider the following statements with reference to the National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) :

- 1. The National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) for FY 2019-25 is a first-of-its-kind, whole-of-government exercise to provide world-class infrastructure to citizens and improve their quality of life
- 2. It was first announced by the Prime Minister of India Narendra Modi during his 2019 Independence Day speech.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.85) Consider the following statements with reference to the International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO):

1. The International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO) is the international body that brings together the world's securities regulators and is recognized as the global standard setter for the securities sector.

2. The International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) has become an Associate Member of

the International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.86) Which of the following institutes released the Global Forest Goals Report?

- a) UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs
- b) World Forest Organisation
- c) UN Environment Programme
- d) National Alliance of Forest Owners

Q.87) Consider the following pairs:

<u>Strait</u>	<u>Connected Water</u>
Bodies.	
1. Bosphorus Strait	- Sea of Marmara and Black Sea
2. Strait of Magellan	- South Pacific Ocean and South Atlantic Ocean
3. Dardanelles Strait	- Sea of Marmara and Aegean Sea
4. Strait of Bab el Mandeb	- Red Sea and Gulf of Aden
5. Cook strait	- Sea of Japan and South Pacific Ocean

Which of the pairs given above is/are matched correctly ?

- a) 1, 3 and 5 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2, 4 and 5 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only

Q.88) With reference to The Climate Breakthroughs Summit, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It aims to demonstrate the need for systemic change to accelerate the global transition to a **zero-carbon economy**.

2. Race to zero campaign is one of initiative of Climate Breakthroughs Summit

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.89) Caspian sea is the border of which of the following countries ?

- 1. Turkey
- 2. Turkmenistan
- 3. Iraq
- 4. Kazakhstan

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.90) Consider the following:

- 1. Large sea surface with temperature higher than 27° C
- 2. Presence of the Coriolis force
- 3. Small variations in the vertical wind speed
- 4. A pre-existing strong low-pressure area
- 5. Lower divergence above the sea level system

Which of the above conditions are favourable for the formation and intensification of tropical storms ?

- a) 1,2 and 3 only
- b) 1,3 and 4 only
- c) 3,4 and 5 only
- d) 1,2, and 5 only

Q.91) Consider the following pairs:

<u>TROPICAL CYCLONE</u>	<u>LOCATION</u>
1) Tauktae	– Indian Ocean
2) Iota	– Western Pacific
3) Surigae	– Atlantic
4) Marcus	– Western Australia

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 1 and 4 only

Q.92) Consider the following:

- 1. Latitude
- 2. Longitude
- 3. Unequal distribution of land and water
- 4. Prevailing wind
- 5. Ocean currents

Which of the above factors are responsible for the distribution of temperature of ocean water ?

- a) 1,2,3 and 4 only
- b) 1,3,4 and 5 only
- c) 2,3,4 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,4 and 5 only



Q.93) Consider the following statements with reference to the SDG India Index 2020–21:

1. The SDG India Index 2020–21 is released by NITI Aayog
2. States and Union Territories are classified on their SDG India Index score as Aspirant, Performer, Front-Runner and Achiever.
3. Top performing state is Kerala and bottom performing state is Jharkhand.

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct ?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.94) Consider following statements regarding pallava dynasty:

1. All the rulers of the pallava dynasty practiced hindu religion.
2. Pallava ruler Narsimhavarman defeated Satavahanas and took control over vatapi and nearby regions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- a) only 1
- b) only 2
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.95) Consider Following statements regarding Bodoland Territorial Region:

1. The region is an autonomous region in Assam situated on the north bank of Brahmaputra river.
2. It consists of Kokrajhar, Baksa, Chirang, Udulgiri districts of Assam.

Which of the above statements are correct ?

- a) Only 1
- b) Only 2
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.96) Consider the following statements regarding CBI:

1. CBI works under the superintendence of the Home Ministry.
2. The Institution of Lokpal exercises superintendence over CBI under the prevention of corruption act, 1988.
3. CBI director is provided with security of tenure.
4. CBI has restricted powers to take suo-motu action during its investigations.

Which of the above is/are correct statements ?

- a) 1 and 2 Only
- b) 1, 2 and 3 Only

- c) 3 and 4 Only
- d) All of the above.

Q.97) Consider the following measures as suggested by the latest Economic Survey:

1. Formulation of the Labor codes.
2. Increased FDI limit in the defense sector to 74% under automatic route.
3. Relaxation of withdrawal norms under Consolidated Sinking Funds.
4. Enactment of the farm laws.

Which of the following measures form part of the structural reforms for the recovery of the Indian economy post the shock posed by the COVID-19 pandemic?

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Q.98) Consider the following statements:

1. The National Startup Advisory Council is chaired by the Minister of Finance.
2. Sahakar Mitra is a paid internship programme for startups under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.99) Consider the following initiatives:

1. Entrepreneurship Development Institute
2. Women Entrepreneurship Programme
3. India Innovation Index
4. Export Preparedness Index

Which of the initiatives given above is/are associated with NITI Aayog?

- a) 1, and 4 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, 3, and 4 only
- d) 3 only

Q.100) Consider the following statements.

1. Advice tendered by the Supreme Court on removal of chairman of Union Public service Commission on grounds of 'misbehaviour' is binding on the President.
2. A public servant under the All India services can move to court if the Government without



consulting the Union Public Service Commission
has dismissed him/her from service.

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

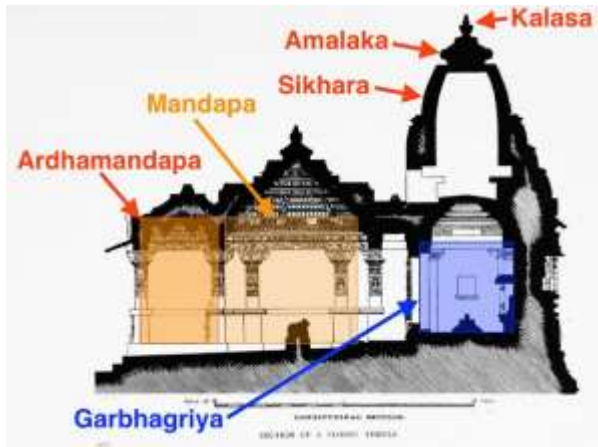
- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

OnlyIAS

Q.1) Ans: B

Exp:

- Statement 1 is incorrect and 2 is correct



- The entire temple is built on a stone platform with steps leading up to it. However, It **does not usually have elaborate boundary walls or gateways** as in South India (**Dravida Style Architecture**).
- The cave-like sanctum that houses the main deity (Called **Garbhagriha**) is always **located directly below the tallest tower**.
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - The pyramidal spire over the garbhagriha is called **Shikhara**. The Dravida equivalent of this tower is **Vimana**.
 - There are many subdivisions of **nagara** temples depending on the shape of the **shikhara** such as:
 - **Rekha-Prasada** : Square at the base and whose walls curve or slope inward to a point.
 - **Phamsana**: Tends to be broader and shorter than the Rekha prasada shikhara.
 - **Valabhi** : Rectangular buildings with a roof that rises into a vaulted chamber.

while the shaft of **Achaemenian** pillars were made up of various pieces of **sandstone cemented** together.

- The Ashokan pillars were **independently erected by royal diction** and were Free standing monuments. The **Achaemenid pillars**, on the other hand, were generally attached to state buildings and **served as supporting structures**
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - All the pillars of Ashoka were built at **Buddhist monasteries**, many important sites from the **life of the Buddha** and places of pilgrimage. Some of the columns carry **inscriptions addressed to the monks and nuns**.
 - Ashoka used the expression Dharma stambha i.e. "**pillars of the Dharma**" to describe his own pillars. The inscriptions on the **pillars** set out **edicts** about morality based on **Buddhist** tenets. **The Edicts of Ashoka are a collection of more than thirty inscriptions on the pillars**, as well as boulders and cave walls.
 - These inscriptions were dispersed throughout the areas of modern-day Bangladesh, India, Nepal, Afghanistan and Pakistan, and provide the first tangible evidence of Buddhism. The **edicts describe in detail Ashoka's view about dhamma**, an earnest attempt to solve some of the problems that a complex society faces.

Q.3) Ans: C

Exp:

- Some famous edicts of Ashoka:
 - Rummindei Pillar Edicts (NEPAL): The inscriptions mention Ashoka's **visit to Lumbini (Rummindei)**, Rupandehi district, Nepal, the **birthplace of Lord Buddha**. Ashoka exempted Lumbini from paying tax, and fixed its contribution of grain at one – eighth. The inscriptions are written in the Brahmi script.



SOURCE : NCERT

Q.2) Ans: C

Exp:

- Statement 1 is correct and 2 is incorrect:
 - The shaft of the **Ashokan** pillars were **monolithic**, i.e. they were inscribed from a single piece of stone, mainly **chunar sandstones**

- **Kalsi Inscription (Uttarakhand)** : The site of Ashoka's inscriptions at Kalsi is singularly unique as it is the only place in North India where the great Mauryan emperor has inscribed the set of the fourteen rock edicts. The language of these edicts is **Prakrit** and the script is **Brahmi**.
- **Maski Inscription (Karnataka)** : The site has a minor rock edict of Emperor Ashoka. It was the first edict of Emperor Ashoka that contained the name **Ashoka** in it instead of 'Devanampriya' or 'Piyadassi'.
- **Sannati inscription (KANGANHALLI, Karnataka)** : Contains the sculpture-portrait of Emperor Ashoka — the **only available image of the Mauryan emperor (SHOWN HERE)**.

SOURCE : NITIN SINGHANIYA + INTERNET

Q.4) Ans: B

Exp:



- **Pair 1 is correct and Pair 3 is incorrect:**
 - The **Qutub Minar of Mehrauli** was built around **1199** by **Qutub-ud-din** and finally completed by his son-in-law and successor **Iltutmish** (1210-35). Originally the **minar had four storeys**, the uppermost of which was damaged by lightning in 1373. **Feroz Shah Tughlaq (1351- 88)** rebuilt its **two storeys**. It was dedicated to **Qutb-bakhtiyar-kaki**, a Sunni Muslim Sufi mystic, saint and scholar of the Chishti Order.
 - **Adhai-din-ka-Jhonpra at Ajmer** was Designed by **Abu Bakr** of Herat and **constructed by Qutb-ud-Din-Aibak** in **1192 CE**. It was constructed from the material obtained after demolishing Hindu temples. This one is also laid on the same

plan as the Delhi mosque constructed by Qutub-ud-din, with carved pillars used in colonnades.



- **Pair 2 is correct:**



- **Gol Gumbaz is the tomb of king Mohammed Adil Shah, Adil Shahi Dynasty.** Construction of the tomb, located in **Bijapur, Karnataka, India**, was started in 1626 and was completed in 1656. It follows the style of Indo-Islamic architecture. Even a slight whisper by someone standing in its gallery can be heard everywhere else in the gallery, and if somebody claps, the sound of it echoes several times.

SOURCE : [Centre for Cultural Resources and Training \(CCRT\) \(ccrtindia.gov.in\)](http://Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT) (ccrtindia.gov.in))

Q.5) Ans: C

Exp:



- **Option 1 is incorrect:** Bara Imambara, also known as **Asfi Mosque**, is an imambara complex in **Lucknow, India** built by **Asaf-ud-**

Daula, Nawab of Awadh in 1784. The architecture of the complex reflects the maturation of ornamented Mughal design, namely the **Badshahi Mosque** - it is one of the last major projects **not incorporating any European elements** or the use of iron



- **Option 2 is incorrect:** The Rumi Darwaza in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, India, is an imposing gateway which was also built by Nawab Asaf-Ud-Daula in 1784. It is an example of Awadhi architecture. It is **adjacent to the Bara Imambara**. It used to mark the entrance to Old Lucknow City.



- **Option 3 is correct:** Ala'i Darwaza is the southern gateway of the **Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque in Qutb complex**, Mehrauli, Delhi, India. Built by Sultan Alauddin Khalji in 1311 and made of **red sandstone**, it is a **square domed gatehouse with arched entrances** and houses a single chamber. It has a special significance in Indo-Islamic architecture as the **first Indian monument to be built using Islamic methods of construction and ornamentation** and is a World Heritage Site.

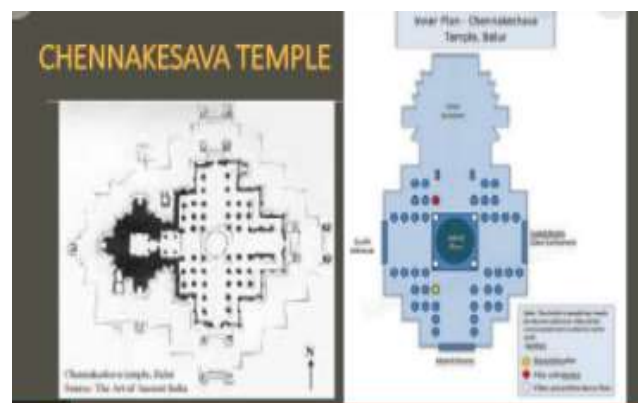


- **Option 4 is incorrect:** Tughlaqabad Fort is a ruined fort in Delhi, built by **Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq, the founder of Tughlaq dynasty**, of the **Delhi Sultanate of India in 1321**, as he established the third historic city of Delhi, which was later abandoned in 1327.

Q.6) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Hoysala dynasty ruled in Deccan India about **1006 to about 1346 CE**. The capital of the Hoysalas was initially located at **Belur but was later moved to Halebidu**. Hoysala architecture developed under the rule of the Hoysala Empire **between the 11th and 14th centuries**, in the region known today as Karnataka, a state of India. Hoysala influence was at its peak in the **13th century**, when it **dominated the Southern Deccan Plateau region**. Examples of the **Hoysala architectural style**, including the **Chennakesava Temple at Belur**, the **Hoysaleswara Temple at Halebidu**, and the **Kesava Temple at Somanathapura**.



- **Statement 2 is correct:** Hoysala temples are sometimes called hybrid or vesara as **their unique style seems neither completely Dravida nor Nagara**, but somewhere in between.

- The plan (top view) of these temples was similar to a **star** and is known as a **stellate plan**.

Q.7) Ans: B

Exp:



- **Dilwara Temples:**

- The Dilwara Temples of Dilwara Temples are a group of svetambara Jain temples located **about 2+1/2 kilometres from the Mount Abu** settlement, Rajasthan's only hill station.
- The earliest were built by **Vimal Shah** and **supposedly designed or at least financed by Vastupala**, Jain minister of Dholka. They date between the **11th and 16th centuries**, forming some of the most famous monuments in the style of **Māru-Gurjara architecture** famous for their use of a very **pure white marble** and **intricate marble carvings**.
- The temples have an opulent entranceway, the simplicity in architecture **reflecting Jain values like honesty and frugality**.



- The **Shore Temple** is so named because it overlooks the shore of the Bay of Bengal at Mahabalipuram (East Coast Road, Tamil Nadu). It is a **structural temple**, built with **blocks of granite (and hence not rock cut)** during the reign of **Narasimhavarmar II of the Pallava dynasty**. As one of the Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram, it has been classified as a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**.

- Other structures at Mahabalipuram such as the **Arjuna and Draupadi Rathas, Dharmaraja Ratha** etc. are examples of **rock cut structures**



- **Option 2 is incorrect:**

- The Ladkhan temple of **Aihole** belongs to the **5th century A.D.** Here the architect has tried to give attention to the **circumambulation path which is enclosed** by means of a wall allowing devotees to have **pradakshina** or **circumambulatory** of the holy of holies. It is not an example of Rock cut architecture.

- **Option 3 is correct:**

Q.8) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option 1 is incorrect:**



- The famous **Kailasa temple at Ellora** is in a class by itself because it is a **rock-cut temple** complex, which in many respects resembles the various rathas at Mahabalipuram. This temple was constructed during the reign of the **Rashtrakuta King Krishna and belongs to the middle of the 8th century A.D.** The carvers at Ellora cut three trenches down into the rock and then began to carve the rock from the top downwards.



- **Option 4 is correct:**
 - Rani ki Vav is a stepwell situated in the town of Patan in Gujarat. Its construction is attributed to Udayamati, daughter of Khengara of Saurashtra, queen of the 11th-century **Solanki dynasty**. It is a **sub terrain rock cut step well** on the banks of the now extinct river Saraswati.

SOURCE : [Centre for Cultural Resources and Training \(CCRT\) \(ccrtindia.gov.in\)](http://Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT) (ccrtindia.gov.in))

Q.9) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Pandrethan Temple:**
 - The **Meruvardhanaswami temple** at **Pandrethan** near **Srinagar** in Jammu and Kashmir. Pandrethan, now mostly in ruins, is **one of Kashmir's historic capitals**, said to have been founded by king Pravarsena in the 6th century AD, according to **Kalhana** in his poetical account of **Kashmiri** history called **Rajatarangini**.



- - The small stone Shiva temple in the picture dates from the mid-10th century, **reputedly erected by a minister named Meru**. It was set in a **spring-fed tank** and its **plinth** is now submerged. Its interior has one of the **finest surviving temple ceilings in Kashmir**, consisting of three intersecting squares formed by diagonally placed lintels, the soffit decorated with a lotus
 - It is situated on the banks of river **Jhelum**.

SOURCE : Kashmir. Temple of Meruvarddhanaswami at Pandrethan near Srinagar. View of north face. Probable date A.D. 913 to 921

Q.10) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Chaturbhuj Temple, dedicated to Vishnu, is situated at Orchha in **Madhya Pradesh, India**. The temple is noted for having **one of the tallest Vimana** among Hindu temples standing at 344 feet. The temple is located in the Orchha town, just outside the limits of the Orchha Fort complex, to the south of the **Rama Raja Temple**. It is on an island **formed by the Betwa River**.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** Omkareshwar is a Hindu temple **dedicated to God Shiva**. It is one of the 12 revered Jyotirlinga shrines of Shiva. It is **on an island called Mandhata or Shivpuri in the Narmada river** at Khandwa district in Madhya Pradesh, India.
- **Pair 3 is incorrect:** **Konark Sun Temple** (Konark Surya Mandir) is a 13th-century CE Sun temple at **Konark**, near Puri on the coastline of Odisha, India. The temple is attributed to king **Narasimhadeva I of the Eastern Ganga Dynasty**. The temple was called the "Black

Pagoda" in **European sailor accounts**. The temple is located just a few 100 metres from the coast (beach) at Chandrabhaga, Odisha. It is **not located on the banks of any major river**.

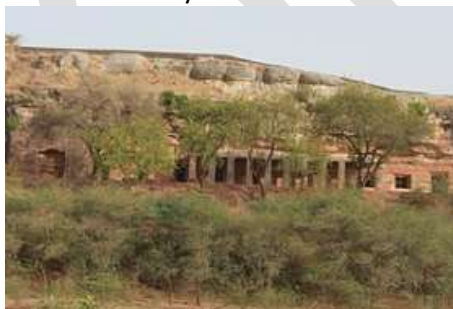
Q.11) Ans: A

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Lomas Rishi Cave is one of the man-made Barabar Caves in the Barabar and Nagarjuni hills of Jehanabad district in the Indian state of Bihar. It was built during the Ashokan period of the Mauryan Empire in the 3rd century BC, as part of the sacred architecture of the Ajivikas, an ancient religious and philosophical group of India that competed with Jainism and became extinct over time.

- **Elephanta Caves (Mumbai, Maharashtra)** are a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a collection of cave temples predominantly dedicated to the Hindu god Shiva. They consist of five Hindu caves and a few Buddhist stupa mounds that date back to the 2nd century BCE



- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Bagh Caves are a group of nine rock-cut monuments, situated among the southern slopes of the Vindhyas in Bagh town of Dhar district in Madhya Pradesh state in central India. These are renowned for mural paintings. Buddhist in inspiration, all of them are 'viharas' or resting places of monk monasteries having a quadrangular plan. There are only two known examples of cave paintings of

the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of **Ajanta Caves** ; the other being **Bagh caves**.



- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Badami cave temples are a complex of Hindu and Jain cave temples located in Badami, a town in the Bagalkot district in the northern part of Karnataka. The caves are important examples of Indian rock-cut architecture, especially Chalukya architecture of the 6th century. They along with the temples in Aihole transformed the Malaprabha River valley into a cradle of temple architecture that influenced the components of later Hindu temples elsewhere in India.

Q.12) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Parchin kari (Pietra Dura):**



- **Pietra dura** in the Indian Subcontinent, is a term for the inlay technique of using cut and fitted, highly polished colored stones to create images. It is considered a decorative art. The stonework, after the work is assembled loosely, is glued stone-by-stone to a substrate.



- **Moti Masjid** or **Pearl Fort**, **Diwan-i-aam**, **Diwan-i-khas**, **Jami Masjid** in New Delhi,

Mausoleum built by **Jahangir** are some of the other examples where this style can be found.

- The particular method of decoration became more popular under **Shah Jahan** who used this technique while constructing the **Taj Mahal**.

Q.13) Ans: B

Exp:

- Statements 1 and 3 are incorrect:



- The Gomateshwara statue is the tallest monolithic statue in the world, carved out of a single block of **granite**. It is located on the **Vindhyagiri hill at Shravanabelagola**. The Gomateshwara statue is dedicated to the **Jain figure Bahubali, the son of Rishabhanatha (the 1st tirthankar of Jainism)**. The **Mahamastakabhisheka** festival is held once in 12 years, when the Gomateshwara statue is anointed with milk, saffron, ghee, sugarcane juice (ishukrasa) etc. from the top of the statue.
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - It was commissioned by **Chavundaraya, the General-in-Chief and Prime Minister of the Ganga Kings of Mysore**. They ruled in ancient Karnataka from about **350 to 1000 CE**. Chavundaraya was inspired by Jain Acharya, Nemichandra **Siddhanta Chakravartin** and decided to build the statue of Bahubali.

Q.14) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Dhauli** is located on the banks of the **river Daya**, south of **Bhubaneswar** in Odisha, India. Dhauli hill is presumed to be the area where the **Kalinga War** was fought.



- After his conquest of the kingdom of Kalinga in modern day Orissa, struck with remorse at the suffering he caused, **Ashoka converted to Buddhism and spent the rest of his life propagating his dharma (law)**. In order to achieve this, he had numerous edicts inscribed on rocks, pillars and caves, throughout his vast empire. These are written in various vernaculars and represent the earliest written document from the Indic regions. **From these edicts it would appear clear that Ashoka was an extremely tolerant and benevolent monarch.**

SOURCE : [Centre for Cultural Resources and Training \(CCRT\) \(ccrtindia.gov.in\)](http://Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT) (ccrtindia.gov.in))

Q.15) Ans: D

Exp:

- In Nagara style of temple architecture, **Shikharas** were generally of three types:
 1. **Latina or Rekha-prasad:** They were square at the base and the walls curve inward to a point on the top
 2. **Phamsana:** They had a broader base and were shorter in height than the Latina ones. They slope upwards on a straight line.
 3. **Valabhi:** They had a rectangular base with the roof rising into vaulted chambers. They were also called wagon-vaulted roofs.
- The vertical end of the shikhara ended in a horizontal fluted disc, known as the **Amalak**. On top of that, a spherical shape was placed known as the **Kalash**.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 1

Q.16) Ans: D

Exp:

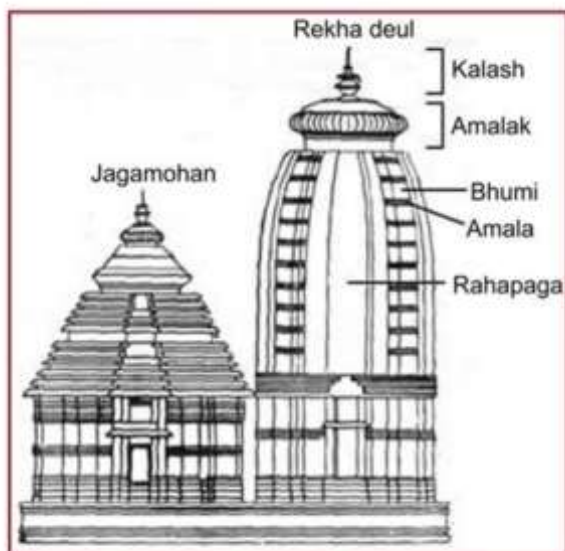


Fig. 1.22: Basic Structure of a Temple under Odisha School of Architecture.

- Odisha school emerged as a sub-school under the **Nagara School**, some of its features were:
 - The exterior walls were **lavishly decorated with intricate carvings**, but interior walls were plain.
 - There was **no use of pillars in the porch**. Iron girders were used instead to support the roof.
 - The shikhara in the Odisha school was known as **rekha deul**. They were almost vertical roofs which suddenly curved inwards sharply.
 - The mandap was known as **jagamohan** in this region.
 - The ground plan of the main temple was square.
 - Temples were **surrounded by a boundary wall** as in Dravidian style of temple architecture.
- Sun Temple at Konark** is known as Black Pagoda, **Jagannath temple at Puri** and **Lingaraj temple in Bhubaneswar** are examples of Odisha school of temple architecture.
- Kandariya Mahadeva Temple** is an example of Khajuraho school of temple architecture.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 1

Q.17) Ans: C

Exp:

Dravidian style of temple architecture

- After the decline of the Pallava dynasty, temple architecture acquired a new style under the **Chola kingdom**, known as the Dravidian style of temple architecture. This marked a new era in the development of temples in South India.
- It was a **continuation of the previous Pallava architecture**, with some variations. This is what came to be known as the Dravidian style of temple architecture.
- Brihadeeswara Temple at Thanjavur** (built by Raja Raja I in 1011 AD), **Gangaikondacholapuram Temple** (built by Rajendra I to commemorate his victory in the Gangetic delta), etc. are examples of Dravidian style of temple architecture.

The features of the Dravidian style:

- Unlike the Nagara temples, the Dravidian temples **were surrounded by high boundary walls**.
- The front wall had a high entrance gateway known as **gopuram**.
- The temple premise was laid out in **panchayatana style** with a principal temple and four subsidiary shrines.
- Under Dravidian style, the spire is in the form of a stepped pyramid that rises up linearly rather than curved. It is known as **vimana**.
- The crowning element is shaped in the form of an **octagon and is known as shikhara**. It is similar to the kalash of the Nagara temple, but **not spherical**.
- There is **only one vimana** in the Dravidian architecture on top of the main temple. **The subsidiary shrines do not have vimanas**, unlike Nagara architecture.
- The assembly hall was connected with the garbhagriha by a vestibular tunnel known as **antarala**.
- The entrance of the garbhagriha had **sculptures of Dwaarpal, mithun and yaksha**.
- The **presence of a water tank inside the temple enclosure** was a unique feature of the Dravidian style.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 1

Q.18) Ans: C



Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** This great art originated in SUB HIMALAYAN STATES, in the first half of the 18th century when a family of Kashmiri painters trained in Mughal painting Style.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Basohli painting is a reputed school of miniature paintings known for its vivid, evocative colors, bold lines, and deep-set facial patterns. This style of painting saw its best years in the 17-18th century. Basholi (Basoli) is a town in Kathua district in the state of Jammu and Kashmir, India.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Kangra paintings influenced by the Bhagavad Purana portrayed incidents from the life of the young Krishna, against the Brindavan forest or river Yamuna. The other popular themes were the stories of Nala and Damayanti, and those from Keshavdas's Baramasa. Gita Govinda, Bhagavata purana and satsai are among the several famous subjects of this style of painting.

Q.19) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Jogimara Caves** in the Ramgarh hills in Surguja district of **Chhattisgarh** houses some of the prehistoric paintings and these are dated to be painted around **1000 BC**. Chhattisgarh is also home to the variety of caves in the district of Kanker like **the shelters of Udkuda, Garagodi, Khaikheda, Gotitola, Kulgaon, etc.** These shelters depict the human figurines, animals, palm prints, bullock carts, etc. which show a higher and sedentary type of living.
- **The Bhimbetka caves of Madhya Pradesh** were discovered in 1957–58 by eminent archaeologist **V.S. Wakankar** and later on many more were discovered. **The first set of prehistoric paintings have been discovered in Bhimbetka caves.** It was also declared as a **UNESCO World heritage site** in 2003.
- **Narsinghgarh in Madhya Pradesh** have paintings to show skins of spotted deer left for drying that provides credence to the theory that the art of tanning skins was perfected by man for providing shelter and clothing.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 2

Q.20) Ans: B

Exp:

- One of the oldest surviving murals of Indian sub-continent, **Ajanta caves were carved between 2nd century BC to 5th century AD** out of volcanic rocks. It consists of a set of **29 caves**, carved in a horse-shoe shape. These Buddhist caves are quite popular for their exquisite **mural paintings**.
- The walls of the caves have **both murals and fresco paintings (painted on wet plaster)**. They use **tempera** style, i.e. use of pigments. The common themes of these paintings range from **Jataka stories to the life of Buddha** to elaborate decorative patterns of flora and fauna. **The medium of painting was vegetable and mineral dyes.** The outline of the figures is in **red ochre, with contours of brown, black or deep red.**

Important paintings at Ajanta are:

- Scenes from the **Jataka stories of the Buddha's former lives** as a Bodhisattva, the life of Gautam Buddha, etc.
- Paintings of various Bodhisattvas in **tribhanga pose in Cave No. 1: Vajrapani (protector and guide, a symbol of Buddha's power)**, Manjusri (manifestation of Buddha's wisdom) and Padmapani (Avalokitesvara) (symbol of Buddha's compassion).
- **The Dying Princess** in Cave No. 16.
- Scene of **Shibi Jataka**, where King Shibi offered his own flesh to save the pigeon.
- Scene of **Matri-Poshaka Jataka** where the ungrateful person saved by an elephant, gives out his whereabouts to the king.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 2

Q.21) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct : Luddi Dance** is a traditional folk dance of Punjab. It is a dance of victory performed by men.
- **Pair 2 is correct. : Thang-ta** is a martial dance form of **Manipur**. It is an evolved and sophisticated repertoire of martial dances, the dancers use swords, spears and shields. Real fight scenes



between the dancers show an extensive training and control of the body

- **Pair 3 is correct** : **Mosak Sumani** is a popular and beautiful dance form of the Tribes of **Tripura** related to hunting of wild animals. The hunting sequences are shown in great style through gestures and postures in rhythmic steps. It is performed by the Tripuri, Noatia, Murasing communities of Tripura.
- **Pair 4 is Incorrect** : **Purulia Chhau** is one of the three styles of semi classical Indian dance Chhau with martial, tribal, and folk traditions, in the state of **West Bengal**. The Purulia Chhau dance is celebrated during the Sun festival. The Chhau mask of Purulia is registered under Geographical Indications. As the basic difference of Purulia Chhau, the mask is unique and traditional.

Q.22) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** : The **Kalbelia** is a dance form that is associated with a **Rajasthani tribe** of the same name kalbelia. The dance form consists of swirling and graceful movements that make this dance a treat to behold. Kalbelia dance is included in UNESCO's list of the Cultural Heritage of Humanity from the year 2010.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** : The dancers are women in flowing black skirts who dance and swirl, replicating the movements of a serpent. The clothes are mixed in red and black hues and embroidered in unique patterns.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : Kalbelia dance has a traditional musical instrument which is **Poongi** also called **been**. Other traditional musical instruments used by the Kalbelia tribe in Kalbelia dance are Dufli, Morchang, Dholak, Khanjari and Khuralio.

Extra Edge by Only IAS

Performed By: Women from Kalbelia community.

Performance Occasions: Kalbelia songs are based on stories taken from folklore and mythology and special dances are performed during Holi

Source of reference : <https://ich.unesco.org/en/RL/kalbelia-folk-songs-and-dances-of-rajasthan-00340>

Indian art and culture Nitin Singhania, CCRT Website

UPSC question referred for this: 2017 PRELIM SET A Q.12

Q.23) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** : **Sattriya** originated in Sattria monastery, as a part of neo-Vaishnavite movement started by **Srimanta Sankardev in Assam**, in the 15th Century. It is one of the major classical dances from the state of Assam.
- **Statement 2 is correct** : One-act plays of *Sattriya* are called *Ankiya Nat*, which combine the aesthetic and the religious through a ballad, dance and drama. The plays are usually performed in the dance community halls, namghar or monastery temples and sattras.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : The themes played are related to Lord Krishna, sometimes other Vishnu avatars such as **Rama and Sita** and stories from epics like Mahabharata and Ramayana are also referred to as Sattriya dances.

Extra Edge by Only IAS

- Sattriya dances differ from other dance forms in their basic stance. For male it is known as **Purush Pak** while for females, **Prakriti Pak**. The dance is based on mythological themes.
- They have special mnemonic bols, typical Assamese music known as **Borgeet**, musical instruments like **large cymbals, drums, colourful costumes**.
- The Corpus of Sattriya dances consists of **ankiya bhaona** and also **Ojapali dances** in which the main singer sings and enacts abhinaya, telling stories and a group of dancers dance as back up dancers playing small cymbals.

Source of reference : Indian art and culture Nitin Singhania, CCRT Website



UPSC question referred for this: 2017 PRELIM SET A

Q.12

Q.24) Ans: C

Exp:

- Bharatnatyam derives its name from 'Bharata Muni' and 'natyam' which means dance in Tamil. In the early 19th century, four dance teachers of Thanjavur namely: Chiniah, Ponniah, Vadivelu and Shivanandam (Tanjore Quartet) defined the **elements of Bharatanatyam recital**. They are as follows:
 - **Alarippu**: It is an invocatory piece of performance which includes basic dance postures and is accompanied with rhythmic syllables. It is meant to seek the blessings of God.
 - **Jatiswaram**: It is the basic dance steps and is devoid of expressions, it includes the different poses and movements.
 - **Shabdham**: The dramatic element with expressed words, which includes the abhinaya in the song. It is generally in praise of the glory of God.
 - **Varnam**: It is the basic dance step component and is a combination of dance and emotions, and is the most important part of the whole performance. It is synchronised with tala and raag, to express the story.
 - **Padam**: It refers to the mastery over the expression of the spiritual message, by the artist. Music becomes light, dance becomes emotional.
 - **Jawali**: These are short lived lyrics performed at a faster tempo
 - **Thillana**: The concluding stage of the performance, and comprises pure dance with exuberant movement and intricate rhythmic variations.

Q.25) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**: Presently there are eight classical dances that are recognised by Sangeet Natak Akademi along with the Union Ministry of Culture. These are :
 - Bharatanatyam from Tamil Nadu
 - Kuchipudi from Andhra Pradesh

- Kathakali from Kerala
- Mohiniattam from Kerala
- Odissi from Odisha
- Manipuri from Manipur
- Kathak from Uttar Pradesh
- Sattriya from Assam
- **Statement 2 is incorrect**: It is Bharatnatyam and not Sattriya dance that is referred to as 'fire dance'. It is called so because it is considered as the manifestation of fire in the human body. Most of the movements in Bharatanatyam resemble that of a dancing flame.
- **Statement 3 is correct** : The opening item is Mangalacharan where the dancer slowly enters the stage with flowers in her hands and makes an offering to mother earth. This is followed by an invocation to the deity of the dancer's choice. Generally, Ganesha is called upon to grant an auspicious beginning. The item ends with a **nritya** sequence with salutations to God, the Guru and the audience.

Q.26) Ans: B

Exp:

- Folk dance forms are generally spontaneous, crude and performed by masses without any formal training. The folk dances have remained confined to a certain sect of people or at a particular locality, to whom the knowledge has been passed down the ages. Some of the well known folk dances with the region they are concentrated to are as follows:
 - Chau: Jharkhand, Odisha and West Bengal (UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity List)
 - Garba: Gujarat
 - Tarangamel: Goa
 - Ghoomar: Rajasthan
 - Kalbelia : Rajasthan (UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity List)
 - Charba : Himachal Pradesh
 - Bhangra/Giddha : Punjab
 - Raslila : Uttar Pradesh
 - Dadra : Uttar Pradesh
 - Jawara : Madhya Pradesh
 - Matki : Madhya Pradesh
 - Gaur maria: Chattisgarh
 - Alkap : West Bengal
 - Biraha : Bihar
 - Paika : Odisha



- Jat-Jatin : Bihar
- Jhumar : Odisha
- Dandra Jatra : Odisha
- Singhi Chham : Sikkim
- Thangta : Manipur

Q.27) Ans: B

Exp:

- Kathak is a traditional dance form of Uttar Pradesh. Kathak derived its name from the 'Kathika' or the storytellers who recited verse from the epics, with gestures and music.
- Jugalbandi is the main attraction of a kathak recital which shows a competitive play between the dancer and the tabla player. Hence, option a is correct.
- Naga Badha mudra, in which the body is connected through curves in the shape of '8' is an important posture in Manipuri dance form. Hence, option b is incorrect.
- Dhrupad music is generally associated with the kathak dance form. A poetic line set to music is interpreted with gestures in other numbers, such as the tumri, bhajan, dadra - all lyrical musical compositions were introduced during the Mughal period. Hence, option c is correct.
- During the Mughal era, the dance form degenerated into lascivious style and branched off into court dance. It was also influenced by Persian costumes and styles of dancing. Hence, option d is correct.

Q.28) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** Kalbelia is a sensuous folk dance performed by the women of the **Kalbelia Community of Rajasthan**. The costumes and dance movement are similar to that of the serpents. **'Been' (wind instrument played by snake charmers) is the popular musical instrument of this dance form.** UNESCO has inscribed Kalbelia folk songs and dances in the **Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010.**
- **Statement 2 is Correct:** Manipuri dance gained prominence with the **advent of Vaishnavism in the 15th century.** Manipuri dance is **unique in its emphasis on devotion** and not sensuality. The

drum – pung – is an intricate element of the recital. Flute, Khartals (wood clapper), dhols, etc. also accompany music. Compositions of **Jayadeva** and **Chandidas** are used extensively.

- **Statement 3 is Correct:** Originally performed by a group of actors going from village to village, known as **Kusselavas**, **Kuchipudi** derives its name from the village of **Kusselavapuri or Kuchelapuram in Andhra.** A Kuchipudi recital is generally accompanied with **Carnatic music; Violin and Mridangam** being the principal instruments. The recital is in **Telugu language.**

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 6

Q.29) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** Odissi dance form is **unique in its representation of gracefulness, sensuality and beauty.** It is similar to Bharatnatyam in the use of Mudras and postures to express emotions. **The tribhanga posture, i.e. the three-bended form of the body is innate to Odissi dance form.** Also the **'Chowk'** posture with hands spread out depicts masculinity.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** **Nagabandha mudra**, in which the body is connected through curves in the shape of '8' is an important posture in **Manipuri dance form and not kathak.**
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** **Tarangam** is an important posture in **Kuchipudi dance of Andhra Pradesh.** The dancer performs with his/her feet on the edges of a brass plate and balancing a pot of water on the head or a set of diyas.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 6

Q.30) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** Mohiniattam or the **Dance of an Enchantress ('Mohini' meaning beautiful woman and 'attam' means dance),** is essentially a solo dance performance by women. Mohiniattam generally narrates the story of the

feminine dance of Vishnu. Hence, the **Lasya aspect (beauty and grace) of dance is dominant** in a Mohiniattam recital.

- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** Both Odissi dance and kathak are accompanied by **Hindustani classical music** and instruments generally used are **Manjira (Cymbals), Pakhawaj (Drums), Sitar, Flute, etc.** Kathak dance especially is accompanied with **dhrupad music**.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect:** A Kuchipudi recital is generally accompanied with **Carnatic music; Violin and Mridangam** being the principal instruments. The recital is in **Telugu language**. Both Lasya and Tandava elements are important in the Kuchipudi dance form.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 6

Q.31) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Oldest among all classical dance forms, Bharatnatyam derives its name from Bharata Muni and 'natyam' which means dance in Tamil.** The origins of this dance form can be traced back to **'Sadir' – the solo dance performance of the temple dancers or 'devadasis' in Tamil Nadu, hence it was also referred to as 'Dashiattam'.**
- In the early 19th century, four dance teachers of Thanjavur defined **the elements of a Bharatnatyam recital**. They are:
 - **Alarippu** – It is an invocatory piece of performance which includes basic dance postures and is accompanied with rhythmic syllables. It is meant to seek the blessings of God.
 - **Jatiswaram** – It is the Nritta component and is devoid of expressions, it includes the different poses and movements.
 - **Shabdham** – It is the dramatic element with expressed words, which includes the abhinaya in the song. It is generally in praise of the glory of God.
 - **Varnam** – It is the Nritya component. It is a combination of dance and emotions, and is the most important part of the whole performance. It is synchronised with tala and raag, to express the story.

- **Padam** – It refers to a mastery over the abhinaya (expression) of the spiritual message, by the artist. Music becomes light, dance becomes emotional.
- **Jawali** – These are short love-lyrics performed at a faster tempo.
- **Thillana** – It is the concluding stage of the performance, and comprises pure dance (Nritta) with exuberant movement and intricate rhythmic variations.

- Bharatnatyam is often referred to as the **'fire dance'**, as it is the manifestation of fire in the human body. Most of the movements in Bharatanatyam resemble that of a dancing flame.
- **In this dance form, equal emphasis is given on both the Tandava and Lasya aspects of dance, with major emphasis on 'mudras'.** One of the principal mudras is **'Katakamukha Hasta'**.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 6

Q.32) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is Incorrect:** **Khongjom Parba** is an important folk music from the **State of Manipur**. It is a popular ballad genre which is a musical narration of the **battle of Khongjom** fought between the British army and the Manipuri resistance forces in 1891.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** **Maand** is a folk music from the **State of Rajasthan**. It is said to have developed in the royal courts and hence is also recognised in the classical circles. The songs are usually about the bards singing the **glory of the Rajput rulers. It is considered close to Thumri or Ghazal**. The famous song **Kesariya Balam** is in Maand style.
- **Pair 3 is Incorrect:** **Ovi** is a form of music from **Maharashtra and Goa**. They are usually the songs of women i.e., they are sung by women during leisure time and when they are completing their household work. They usually contain four **small lines of poetry**. These are usually songs written for marriages, pregnancy and also lullabies for children.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 5



Q.33) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect:** Amir Khusrau (1253–1325) is credited with the origin of **Qawwali, Khayal, Tarana and Ghazal**, however Thumri was not invented by Amir Khusrau.
- **Statement 2 is Correct:** He is also credited with enriching Indian classical music by introducing **Persian and Arabic elements** in it, and was the originator of the **khayal and tarana styles of music**. He invented the musical instrument **Sehtar** (a three string instrument).

Extra Edge by Only IAS

Amir Khusrau(1253–1325):

- Amir Khusrow was a **Sufi mystic** and a spiritual disciple of **Nizamuddin Auliya**. He was a poet as well as a prolific musician.
- His primary language to write poems was Persian but he composed almost half a million verses in **Persian, Turkish, Arabic, Braj Bhasha, Hindavi as well as the Khadi Boli**.
- His **Khaliq-e-bari**, which is known as the oldest printed dictionary of the world, deals with Hindi and Persian words.
- He is regarded as the **“father of qawwali”**. His association with various sultans enabled him to travel and stay in various parts of India and this gave him exposure to various local traditions. This helped him to assimilate diverse musical influences.
- He was patronized by three **Khilji rulers** successively. It is said that he was also one of the first expounders of the art of making **Ghazal**.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 5

Q.34) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** Purandara Dasa - (1484-1564) is one of the earliest founding proponents of Carnatic music. Hence, he was also widely

referred to as **“Pitamaha or father/grandfather of Carnatic Music”**.

- **Statement 2 is Correct:** Purandara Dasa (1484-1564) and Annamacharya— (1408-1503) as evident were contemporaries. Annamacharya is also the **first known composer of Carnatic Music**:
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect:** Purandar Dasa was a devotee of **Lord Krishna** and his many compositions were devoted to Lord Krishna. Annamacharya, on the other hand, composed sankeertanas in praise of **Lord Venkateswara**, a form of Lord Vishnu.
- **Statement 4 is Incorrect:** Dasa Sahithya is a famous composition of Purandar Dasa and not Annamacharya. Purandar Dasa is also believed to be an avatar or incarnation of sage Narada.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 5

Q.35) Ans: A

Exp:

The Carnatic music is **kriti based** and focuses more on the **saahitya or the lyric quality of the musical piece**. The **Kriti is a highly evolved musical song** set to a certain raga and fixed tala or rhythmic cycle. The Carnatic branch creates music that is played in the traditional octave.

Every composition in the Carnatic style has several parts to it:

- **Pallavi:** The first or the second thematic lines of the composition are referred to as ‘Pallavi’. This portion is often repeated in each stanza. This is considered to be the **‘Piece de Resistance’** or the best part of the Carnatic composition called **‘Ragam Thanam Pallavi’** where the artist has great scope for improvisation.
- **Anu Pallavi:** Two lines called Anu Pallavi follow the Pallavi or the first line. It is **sung in the beginning** and sometimes also towards the end of the song, but it is not necessary to repeat it after every stanza or Charanam.
- **Charana:** This is the **final and the longest verse which concludes the song**.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 5



Q.36) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect.** Gombeyatta puppet is a strong puppet show from the Indian state of Karnataka.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** Gombeyatta are styled and designed like the characters of Yakshagana, the traditional theatre form of Karnataka. Hence Gombeyatta is also called "Yakshagana Gombeyatta". Episodes enacted in Gombeyatta are usually based on Prasangas of the Yakshagana plays. The music that accompanies is dramatic and beautifully blends folk and classical elements
- **Statement 3 is correct.** The Gombeyatta puppet figures are highly stylized and have joints at the legs, shoulders, elbows, hips and knees. These puppets are manipulated by five to seven strings tied to a prop. Some of the more complicated movements of the puppet are manipulated by two to three puppeteers at a time.

Extra Edge by Only IAS

STRING PUPPETRY	STATE
1. Kathputli	Rajasthan
2. Kundhei	Odisha
3. Bommalattam	Tamilnadu
4. Gombeyatta	Karnataka.

Source of reference : CCRT Indian Art and Culture, Indian Art and Culture By Nitin Singhania.

UPSC question referred for this: UPSC CSE PRELIM SET A Q.12

Q.37) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct :** In Kerala, the traditional glove puppet play is called Pavakoothu, the height of the puppet varies from one foot to two feet. The head and arms are carved of wood and joined together with thick cloth, cut and stitched into a small bag.

- **Pair 2 is incorrect :** The traditional rod puppet form of West Bengal is known as Putul Nautch. They are carved from wood and follow the various artistic styles of a particular Nadia region in West Bengal.
- **Pair 3 is correct :** The Ravana Chhaya shadow puppet show belongs to Orissa. The puppets are in one piece and have no joints. They are not coloured, hence throw opaque shadows on the screen. The manipulation requires great dexterity, since there are no joints.
- **Pair 4 is incorrect :** The string puppets of Orissa are known as Kundhei. Made of light wood, the Orissa puppets have no legs but wear long flowing skirts. They have more joints and are, therefore, more versatile, articulate and easy to manipulate. The puppeteers often hold a wooden prop, triangular in shape, to which strings are attached for manipulation.

Source of reference : CCRT Indian Art and Culture, Indian Art and Culture By Nitin Singhania.

UPSC question referred for this: UPSC PRELIM 2018 SET C Q. 64

Q.38) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect :** The earliest reference to the art of puppetry is found in Tamil classic 'Silappadikaram' written around the 1st or 2nd century B.C.
- Natyashastra, the masterly treatise on dramaturgy written sometime during 2nd century BC to 2nd century AD., does not refer to the art of puppetry but the producer-cum-director of the human theatre has been termed as 'Sutradhar' meaning the holder of strings. The word might have found its place in theatre-terminology long before Natyashastra was written but it must have come from marionette theatre. Puppetry, therefore, must have originated in India more than 500 years before Christ.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The excavation sites at Harappa and Mohenjo Daro have yielded puppets with sockets attached to them, which suggests the presence of puppetry as an art form at that time.

Q.39) Ans: C



Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct : Kathputli (Rajasthan)** - The traditional marionettes of Rajasthan are known as Kathputli. Carved from a single piece of wood, these puppets are like large dolls that are colourfully dressed. Their costumes and headgears are designed in the medieval Rajasthani style of dress.
- **Pair 2 is correct: Kundhei (Odisha)** - The string puppets of Orissa are known as Kundhei. Made of light wood, the Odisha puppets have no legs but wear long flowing skirts. They have more joints and are, therefore, more versatile, articulate and easy to manipulate.
- **Pair 3 is incorrect: Gombeyatta (Karnataka)**: The string puppets of Karnataka are called Gombeyatta. They are styled and designed like the characters of Yakshagana, the traditional theatre form of the region. The Gombeyatta puppet figures are highly stylized and have joints at the legs, shoulders, elbows, hips and knees. These puppets are manipulated by five to seven strings tied to a prop.
- **Pair 4 is incorrect: Bommalattam (Tamil Nadu)** - Bommalattam combines the techniques of both rod and string puppets. They are made of wood and the strings for manipulation are tied to an iron ring which the puppeteer wears like a crown on his head.
- **Pair 5 is incorrect: Tholu Bommalata (Andhra Pradesh)** - It is a type of shadow theatre that has the richest and strongest tradition. The puppets are large in size and have jointed waist, shoulders, elbows and knees. They are coloured on both sides. Hence, these puppets throw coloured shadows on the screen. The theme of the puppet plays are drawn from the Ramayana, Mahabharata and Puranas.
- **Pair 6 is correct: Yamapuri (Bihar)** - The traditional Rod puppet of Bihar is known as Yampuri. These puppets are made of wood. Unlike the traditional Rod puppets of West Bengal and Orissa, these puppets are in one piece and have no joints. As these puppets have no joints, the manipulation is different from other Rod puppets and requires greater dexterity.

- The traditional **rod puppet form of West Bengal** is known as **Putul Natch**. They are carved from wood and follow the various artistic styles of a particular region.
- In Nadia district of West Bengal, rod-puppets used to be of human size like the Bunraku puppets of Japan. This form is now almost extinct.
- The Bengal rod-puppets, which survive are about 3 to 4 feet in height and are costumed like the actors of Jatra, a traditional theatre form prevalent in the State. These puppets have mostly three joints. The heads, supported by the main rod, are joined at the neck and both hands attached to rods are joined at the shoulders.
- While the puppeteers themselves sing and deliver the stylized prose dialogues, a group of musicians, usually three to four in numbers, sitting at the side of the stage provide the accompanying music with a drum, harmonium and cymbals. The music and verbal text have close similarity with the Jatra theatre.

Source - CCRT

Q.41) Ans: A

Exp:

- In Kerala, the **traditional glove puppet play** is called **Pavakoothu**. It came into existence during the 18th century due to the **influence of Kathakali**, the famous classical dance-drama of Kerala, on puppet performances. In Pavakoothu, the height of a puppet varies from one foot to two feet. The head and the arms are carved of wood and joined together with thick cloth, cut and stitched into a small bag.
- The faces of the puppets are decorated with paints, small and thin pieces of gilded tin, the feathers of the peacock, etc. The manipulator puts his hand into the bag and moves the hands and head of the puppet. The musical instruments used during the performance are Chenda, Chengilola, Ilathalam and Shankha the conch. The theme for Glove puppet plays in Kerala is based on the episodes from either the Ramayana or the Mahabharata.
- Heavy influence of Kathakali dance form can also be seen in this form

Q.40) Ans: B

Exp:

Q.42) Ans: A



Exp:

- Puppets from **Tamil Nadu**, known as **Bommalattam** combine the techniques of both rod and string puppets. They are made of wood and the strings for manipulation are tied to an iron ring which the puppeteer wears like a crown on his head.
- A few puppets have jointed arms and hands, which are manipulated by rods. The Bommalattam puppets are the largest, heaviest and the most articulate of all traditional Indian marionettes. A puppet may be as big as 4.5 feet in height weighing about ten kilograms. Bommalattam theatre has elaborate preliminaries which are divided into four parts - Vinayak Puja, Komali, Amanattam and Pusenkanattam.

Q.43) Ans: D

Exp:

- The most theatrically exciting is the Ravan Chaya of Orissa. The important characteristics of Ravan Chaya puppetry are as follows:-
- The puppets are in one piece and have no joints.
- They are not coloured, hence throw opaque shadows on the screen.
- The manipulation requires great dexterity, since there are no joints.
- The puppets are made of deer skin and are conceived in bold dramatic poses.
- Apart from human and animal characters, many props such as trees, mountains, chariots, etc. are also used. Although, Ravan Chaya puppets are smaller in size-the largest not more than two feet have no jointed limbs.
- They create very sensitive and lyrical shadows. Hence, option a, b and c are correctly mentioned.
- The Bommalattam puppets are the largest, heaviest and the most articulate of all traditional Indian marionettes. A puppet may be as big as 4.5 feet in height weighing about ten kilograms. Hence, option d is incorrectly mentioned.

Q.44) Ans: C

Exp:

- Gombeyatta is a traditional string puppet show from the state of Karnataka. A unique feature of this puppetry is that more than one puppeteer is needed to manipulate the puppets.
- Regional Names of Shadow Puppetry in India
 - Andhra Pradesh : Tholu bommalata
 - Karnataka : Togalu gombeyaata
 - Maharashtra : Charma Bahuli Natya
 - Odisha : Ravan Chaya
 - Kerala : Tholapavakoothu
 - Tamil Nadu : Thol Bommalata

Source - CCRT

Q.45) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Jain texts have been divided into religious (canonical) and non-religious (non-canonical) texts. Jain **Agamas** are regarded as the religious texts and are considered sacred. They contain the teachings of the Jain Tirthankaras. They were originally compiled by the Gandharas, chief disciple of Mahavira. However, they were compiled again in the Vallabhi Jain council under the **Svetambara** sect and hence they are not accepted as supreme by the Digambaras.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The compilation of Agamas was done at the Jain council organized at **Vallabhi in Gujarat.** It was done by the **Svetambara** sect.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Jain literature is found in Prakrit, Ardha Magadhi, Sanskrit, Gujarati, Shauraseni, Marathi, and also in Kannada. **Ponna, Pampa, and Ranna** are the Kannada writers who wrote in 9th to 12th century and enriched Jain literature.

Source: nitin Singhania: pg 15.14, 15.15.

Q.46) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Avesta** is regarded as the sacred text dealing with the practices of the **Zorastrian religion.** It contains accounts



of their religious beliefs, practices, and instructions. The language used in this literature is **Avestan** which is similar to that of Sanskrit. **Yasna** is the most important part of the Avesta and contains a collection of texts which is highly revered.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Sangam literature includes the collection of texts belonging to the **300 BC to 300 AD**. It was compiled in the third Sangam or assembly organized during the Pandya times. There are two schools of thought in this: **Aham or Agam** that deal with important aspects of human life like love, sexual pleasure, etc. **Puram** deals with customs, ethics, etc. There are two great epics belonging to the Sangam times: **Silappadikaram** written by **Ilango-Adigal** and **Manimekalai** written by **Satthananar**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Brahmanas** are commentaries to the Veda and are associated with each of the Vedas. They deal with a number of subjects like legends, philosophy, and even explain the vedic rituals. The two Brahmanas associated with the Yajur Veda include: **Taittiriya Brahmana** and the **Shatapatha Brahmana**.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** **Adipurana** is a poetic work of **Pampa**, regarded as the father of Kannada literature. It has been written in the **Champu** style. The Champu style deals with the combination of poetry and prose and has been used in multiple languages like Odia, Telugu, Kannada, and even Sanskrit.

Source: nitin Singhania 15.15, 15.17, 15.5, 15.21

Q.47) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Anandamath** was written by **Bakim Chandra Chatterjee** in **Bengali**. It was from this text that the National song of India, Vande Mataram was taken. **Anandamath** was published in 1882 and deals with the Sanyasi rebellion of 1770 – 1820.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Dingal** and **Pingal** are associated with the literary works of **Rajasthan** during the medieval times. It is a form of

fictional writing and the most important work associated with this style is the **Dhola Maru**.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Saint Jnaneshwar** belongs to **Maharashtra**. A number of works in Marathi were composed by him in the 13th century. He is also regarded as the pioneer of the tradition of Kirtan in Maharashtra and has also written detailed commentary on Bhagwat Gita in Marathi.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The ancient works in Kashmir were dominated by the use of the Sanskrit language while in the Medieval times, the use of Kashmiri language along with the use of Persian and Hindi was witnessed. The **dogri** language gained prominence only after the coming of the Dogra family in 1846 and was not found in the ancient times.

Source: nitin Singhania 15. 25, 15.26

Q.48) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct :** **Gita Govinda** was composed by the famous 12th century poet **Jayadeva**. Jayadeva wrote the **Geet Govinda**, which contains information about the **Rasleela of Krishna in Vrindavan**.
- **Pair 2 is Incorrect :** **Buddha Charita** Is an epic poem on the life of Lord Buddha written in Sanskrit. It was written by a Buddhist philosopher and writer **Ashwaghosh** who was a member of Kanishka's court.
- **Pair 3 is correct :** **Malavikagnimitra**, written by **Kalidasa** in the 5th century CE. The story is about the machinations of King **Agnimitra** to win **Malavika**, a female dance student with whom he is in love.
- **Statement 4 is correct :** **Bana**, also called **Banabhatta**, flourished in the 7th century, famed principally for his chronicle, **Harshacharita** or **Life of Harsha**, depicting the court and times of the Buddhist emperor **Harsha**.

Extra Edge by Only IAS

Ancient Literature	Author
1. Kiratjuniya Bharavi	-



2.	Kumarasambhava, Raghuvarsha,	
	Meghdoota,	
Ritusambara,	- Kalidasa	
	Abhijnana Shakuntalam, Vikramorvashi.	
3.	Mrichchakatikam	-
	Shudraka	
4.	Mudra Rakshas	and
	Devichandraguptam - Vishakhadatta	

Q.

Q.50) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** *Nabakalebar* festival is associated with the state of **Odisha**. It is celebrated at the *Jagannath* Temple in Puri. It is not an annual festival rather observed at a predetermined time of about 8 to 19 years. The *Jagannath* Temple in Puri is an example of the *Odisha* School under the *Nagara* style of architecture. The temple was constructed in the 11th century by the ruler of the Eastern Ganga dynasty, Anantavarman Chodaganga.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** On the day of the *Nabakalebar* festival, the idols of **Lord Jagannath, Subhadra, Balabhadra, and Sudarshan** are replaced with a new idol made of uniquely identified and sacred logs of neem tree. The devotees worship the sacred log of the selected neem tree and also attend the ceremony that marks the replacement of the idols.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** *Rath Yatra* or the Chariot festival of Puri is the largest festival of Odisha. It is marked by the annual procession of the three deities namely: *Lord Jagannath, Balabhadra, and Subhadra* from one temple to another. It is different from the *Nabakalebar* festival that deals with the replacement of the idols of the deities.

Source: nitin Singhania:pg: 20.3, 20.4

Q.51) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** *Eid-ul-Zuha* is celebrated on the 12th month of the Islamic calendar and involves the sacrifice of the Goat. It is celebrated in the honor of **Prophet Ibrahim** who offered the head of his son to Allah. The sacrifice of a goat is done on this day and the meat is distributed to family, friends and amongst the poor. It is after this *Eid* that people begin their pilgrimage to Mecca called Hajj.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** *Muharram* is celebrated on the first month of Islamic calendar. It is celebrated amongst the **Shia Muslims** and is a festival of

Source of reference : Indian Art and Culture By Nitin Singhania. Lucent GK book

UPSC question referred for this: UPSC PRELIM 2020 SET B Q.16

Q.49) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct** - Kharchi Puja is a major festival in the state of Tripura. Kharchi Puja is a way to cleanse Mother Earth. *Ama Pechi*, which is the period before this puja, is considered the menstruation period of the Mother Goddess. Therefore, during this time, the soil is neither dug nor ploughed.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect** - Wangala Festival belongs to Meghalaya and particularly to the Garo tribes. It is also called 100 drums festival. Wangala Festival is a harvest festival held in honour of Saljong, the Sun-god of fertility. The celebration of the Wangala Festival marks the end of a period of toil, which brings good output from the fields. It also signifies the onset of winter.
- **Pair 3 is correct** - Rongkhli is a tribal festival from the state of Meghalaya. It is also called the Tiger festival (rong meaning festival and khli meaning tiger). The festival is celebrated by the jaintia tribes of Meghalaya.
- **Pair 4 is correct** - Losar festival is a popular festive tradition from the state of Arunachal Pradesh. It Marks the start of spring and the first day of the lunar calendar. It is celebrated by the people of the Monpa Tribe who practice agriculture and animal husbandry and follow Buddhist religion.

Source of reference : CURRENT AFFAIRS Indian Art and Culture Nitin Singhania

UPSC question referred for this:



mourning. It is marked by the death of Hussain Bin Ali at the **Battle of Karbala** in 680 AD. People take out **Tajia** procession during the celebration.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Shab-e-Barat** is celebrated in the Islamic month of **Shaban**. It is celebrated to mark the birth anniversary of the 12th imam. It is celebrated mostly by the Shia Muslims.

Source: Nitin Singhania; pg:20.4 and 20.5

Q.52) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** **Maghi** is the annual festival of Sikhs celebrated in the memory of forty sikh martyrs of the Sikh-Muslim war during the war with Mughals. The forty Sikh martyrs are known as the *Chalis Mukte*.
- **Option B is incorrect:** **Parkash Utsav Dasveh Patshah** is celebrated on 31 January every year to mark the birth anniversary of **Guru Gobind Singh**, the 10th guru of Sikhs. **Guru Purab** on the other hand is celebrated to mark the birth anniversary of the 10 sikh gurus.
- **Option C is correct:** Baisakhi is celebrated in the month of April every year. It is a sikh harvest festival and is marked by the **Sikh new year** and the birth of the **Khalsa Panth**.
- **Option D is correct:** The festival of **Lohri** is celebrated a day before the **Makar Sankranti** in the month of January. It is a festival of fertility and lights and falls on the month of **Magh** as per the Hindu Calendar.

Source: Nitin Singhania, pg: 20.7, 20.8

Q.53) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Cheti Chand** is celebrated by the **Sindhi community**. It falls on the month of **Chaitra** and is celebrated as the Sindhi New Year. It is celebrated to mark the birth of the **Jhulelal Devta**, worshipped by the Sindhis.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Hemis Gompa** is Buddhist festival and is held at the Hemis Gompa monastery

in Ladakh. It is celebrated to mark the birth of the **Guru Rinpoche** who is regarded as the founder of the **Tibetan Buddhism**. The **Llamas** perform dances with masks on their faces and this is the prime attraction of this festival. Along with the dance, music using drums, cymbals, trumpets, etc. is played on this occasion.

Source: nitin Singhania;pg: 20.11

Q.54) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Dree** festival is observed in the Ziro valley in Arunachal Pradesh among the **Apatani** tribes living there. It is a harvest festival celebrated with traditional dance performances. Cucumber is distributed to the attendees of this festival as a mark to indicate the good harvest.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Moatsu Mong** is celebrated among the **Ao tribes** in **Nagaland**. It is celebrated after the sowing is done and is marked by singing and dancing. **Sangpantu** is a part of this festival where the people light a big bonfire and sit around it.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Kang Chingba** is also regarded as the **Ratha Yatra of Manipur**. It is similar to the Ratha Yatra of Jagannath Puri. It is a 10 day long festival and celebrates the holy yatra of Shri Govindajee from one temple to another. It is regarded as one of the largest Hindu festivals of the state of Manipur.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** **Khan** festival is celebrated amongst the Miji tribe of Arunachal Pradesh. It is marked by the tying of a sacred thread made of wool. The festival sees participation of people belonging to different castes and creeds.

Source: Nitin Singhania,pg: 20.16,17,18,19

Q.55) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Kumbha Mela** is regarded as one of the largest religious gatherings of the world where a large number

of people come to take a dip in the holy rivers. It is observed in the Indian cities of **Ujjain**, **Nashik**, **Prayagraj**, and **Haridwar**. It is held every 12 years in these four cities on a rotational basis. In the case of **Prayagraj and Haridwar**, **Ardh-Kumbha** is organized after every six years.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** At **Nashik and Ujjain**, if the **Kumbh Mela** falls when Jupiter is in Leo or Simha rashi as per the Hindu astrology, then the Kumbha is referred to as the **Simhastha Kumbha**. Nashik is situated on the banks of **Godavari** and Ujjain on the banks of **Shipra**. Hence, the Kumbha Mela organized at these locations when Jupiter is associated with Leo is referred to as **Simhastha Kumbha**.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Kumbha Mela** was added to the **UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2017**. It is associated with the states of **Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and Uttar Pradesh**. Apart from this, **Ramlila** was also added to this list in 2008. **Ramlila** is a folk theatre associated with the state of **Uttar Pradesh**. It is usually organized before the festival of **Dussehra** and involves the enactment of the **Ramayana**.

Source: Nitin Singhania: pg: 20.19, 20.20, 11. 3, 11.6.

Q.56) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Pushkar** and **Sonepur** fairs are organized on the occasion of **Kartik Poornima**. **Pushkar** fair is held in the state of **Rajasthan** while **Sonepur** fair is associated with the state of **Bihar**. In the **Pushkar** fair, a large cattle and camel fair is organized where the sale and purchase of cattle is done. In the **Sonepur** fair, a cattle fair is organized. It is the only fair where the sale of elephants is done at a very large scale. It is believed that **Chandragupta Maurya** brought elephants and horses from this fair.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Shamlaji** fair is organized in the state of **Gujarat** among the **Bhils tribes**. It is organized in reverence of **Lord Shamlaji** who was an incarnation of **Lord Vishnu**. **Kolayat** fair is associated with **Bikaner** in the state of **Rajasthan**. It is named after **Kapil Muni**. It is

marked by the holy bath at the **Kolayat** Lake along with the cattle fair.

Source: nitin Singhania: pg: 20.20, 20.21

Q.57) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Option D is correct:** **Bihu** is the most popular festival associated with the state of **Assam**. There are three Bihus celebrated in Assam: **Rongali or Bohag Bihu**; **Kongali or Kati Bihu**; and **Maagh or Kongali Bihu**. **Rongali or Bohag Bihu** is the most important among the three and is celebrated on the occasion of the **Assamese New Year**. It is celebrated in the month of April and is marked by the **changing seasons** and **harvests**. **Gamosa** or the hand-woven cotton towel along with **Pitha**, a rice dish, is a popular attraction of this festival. Along with this, people also perform **Bihu** dance on the occasion.

Source: nitin Singhania:pg: 20.5

Q.58) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Onam** is celebrated in the State of **Kerala** and falls on the **first month of the Malayalam Calendar**. It is a **harvest festival** of Kerala and also celebrates the homecoming of the **Asura King Mahabali**. The prominent feature of this festival includes the snake boat race or **Vallam Kali** which is held in the **Punnamada** Lake. It is a vibrant colorful festival. Traditional games or **Onakanikal** are also organized during the Onam festival.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It is a festival that fosters communal harmony and is celebrated in **Delhi**. It is also known as the **Phool Walo ki Sair**. The festival involves a procession which carries palm leaves to the **Yogmaya Temple** from the tomb of **Khwaja Bakhtiyar Kaki** in **Mehrauli**. It was patronized by the **Mughal Emperor Akbar II**. The festival was banned by the British but reinstated post independence in 1962.



Source: nitin Singhania, pg: 20.13, 20.14

Q.59) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** *Deepavali* or *Diwali* is the festival of lights. It is celebrated on the day of Amavasya or the New Moon Day in the Hindu month of Kartik. It is celebrated on the next day of Naraka Chaturdashi. Whereas *Dev Deepavali* is also celebrated in the Hindu month of Kartik. Unlike *Deepavali*, it is celebrated on the day of Full Moon or Purnima.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** *Deepavali* is celebrated throughout the country in multiple states of India whereas *Dev Deepavali* is celebrated in the city of Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh. On the occasion of *Dev Deepavali*, the *ghats* of river Ganga are lit up and it is observed as *Tripura Purnima Snan*.

Source: nitin Singhania: pg: 20.3

Q. 60) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** *Channapatna toys* are produced in Channapatana town in **Karnataka**. These are **handmade lacquer wooden toys** and the town is popularly known as **Gombegala Ooru** or the toy-town of Karnataka. The origin of the wooden toys dates back to the **period of Tipu Sultan**, who was a great admirer of wooden toys. The toys have been given the status of **Geographical Indication**.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** *Kondapalli* toys are made of wood in Kondapalli of **Krishna district in Andhra Pradesh**. The artisans who make the toys are referred to as **Aryakhastriyas** (also known as **Nakarshalu**), who have their mention in the **Brahmanda Purana**. It was registered as one of the **Geographical Indication** handicrafts from Andhra Pradesh as per **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999**. The Kondapalli toys are made from **softwood** known as **Tella Poniki** which is found in nearby Kondapalli Hills.

- **Pair 3 is incorrect:** The unique wooden craft of **Kinhal toys from Karnataka** flourished under the royal patronage of **Vijayanagara empire**, when kings invited crafts people from across India to come and work in their capital, Hampi. Kinnala idols are known for their **vibrant colours and glossy finish**. They usually depict **gods, mythological characters or animals**.

Reference:

<https://www.indianmirror.com/culture/indian-specialties/channapatnatoy.html>

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<https://www.artisera.com/collections/kinnala-art>

Q.61) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Samkhya school of philosophy** is the **oldest school of philosophy** and was founded by **Kapil Muni** who is supposed to have written the **Samkhya Sutra**. This school believed in **dualism or dvaitavada**, i.e. the **soul and the matter are separate** entities. This concept is the **basis of all real knowledge**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Samkhya school went through **two phases of development**, i.e. Original Samkhya view and New Samkhya view. Both the schools argued that **salvation** could be attained through the **acquisition of knowledge**. **Knowledge** can be acquired through three main concepts: **Pratyaksha** (perception), **Anumana** (inference), **Shabda** (hearing).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** This school has been famous for their **scientific system of inquiry**. The final philosophy argued that **Prakriti and Purusha** are the **basis of reality** and they are **absolute and independent**. As **Purusha** is closer to the attributes of a **male**, it is associated with consciousness and cannot be changed or altered. Conversely, **Prakriti** consists of three major attributes: **thought, movement and transformation**. These attributes make it closer to the **physiognomy of a woman**.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.62) Ans: A

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Vaisheshika school believes in the **physicality of the Universe** and is considered to be a **realistic and objective philosophy** that governs the Universe. It argued that everything in the **Universe** was created by the **five main elements: fire, air, water, earth and ether (sky)**. These material elements are also called **Dravya**.

Brihaspati laid the foundation of **Charvaka school**. The philosophy is old enough to find mention in the **Vedas** and **Brihadarankya Upanishad**. The Charvakas do not consider 'ether' as one of the five essential elements of earth as it cannot be experienced through perception. Hence, they say the universe consists of **only four elements: fire, earth, water and air**.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Vaisheshika school has a very scientific approach. They also developed the **atomic theory**, i.e. all material objects are made of atoms. They **believed in God** and considered him the **guiding principle**. They also believed that the **laws of Karma guide this universe**.

The **Charvaka school** argued **against the need to achieve salvation** and also **denied the existence of Brahma and God**. They argued against Gods and their representatives on earth – the priestly class. This school argues that there is **no other world after this one**, hence **death is the end** of a human being and **pleasure should be the ultimate objective** of life. Hence, they propound the **theory of 'eat, drink and make merry'**.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.63) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Yoga school literally means the **union of two major entities**. The origin of Yoga and the school have been expounded in the **Yogasutra of Patanjali** that is attributed tentatively to the **2nd century BC**. The **Nyaya school** is supposed to be **founded by Gautama** who is also identified as the **author of Nyaya sutra**. **Kanada**, who also wrote the basic text governing the **Vaisheshika philosophy**, is often considered to be the **founder of this school**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Yoga school argues that human beings can achieve salvation by **combining meditation and physical application of**

yogic techniques. It is argued that these techniques lead to the **release of Purusha** from the **Prakriti** and would eventually **lead to salvation**. The physical aspect of this school deals primarily with exercises in various postures that are also called **asanas**. There are several types of breathing exercises that are called **pranayama**.

The **Nyaya school** believes in the technique of **logical thinking to achieve salvation**. They consider life, death and salvation to be like mysteries that can be solved through logical and analytical thinking.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.64) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The texts that describe the **Mimamsa philosophy** in detail are the **Sutras of Jaimini**, which were supposedly composed in the **3rd century BC**. Further inroads into the philosophy were made by **two of their greatest proponents: Sabar Swami and Kumarila Bhatta**. The oldest text that formed the basis of **Vedanta philosophy** was **Brahmasutra of Badarayana**. But this philosophy evolved in the **9th century AD** through the philosophical intervention of **Shankaracharya** who wrote **commentaries** on the **Upanishads and the Bhagavad Gita**. His changes led to the development of **Advaita Vedanta**. Another major philosopher of this school was **Ramanujan**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The word '**Mimamsa**' literally means the art of **reasoning, interpretation and application**. This school focuses on the **analysis of the texts of Samhita and Brahmana** that are portions of the Vedas. They argue that the **Vedas contain the eternal truth** and they are the **repositories of all knowledge**. **Vedanta** is made of two words- 'Veda' and 'ant', i.e. the end of the Vedas. This school upholds the philosophies of life as elaborated in the **Upanishads**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Mimamsa school** argued that **salvation** is possible through performing rituals but it is also necessary to **understand the justification and reasoning** behind vedic rituals. The **Vedanta philosophy** propounds that **Brahm is the reality of life** and **everything else** is unreal or



Maya. The atma or the consciousness of self is similar to the brahm. This argument equalizes atma and brahma and if a person attains **the knowledge of the self**, he would automatically understand brahm and would **achieve salvation**.

Extra edge by OnlyIAS

- The main focus in the **Mimamsa school** was on the **ritualistic part of the Vedas**. As most humans did not understand the rituals properly, they would have to take **assistance from the priests**. Therefore, this philosophy **inherently legitimized the social distance** between the various classes.
- The **Vedanta theory** also gave credence to the **Theory of Karma**. They believed in the **theory of Punarjanama or rebirth**. They also argued that a person would have to bear the brunt of their actions from the previous birth in the next one.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.65) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Kudiattam, a Sanskrit theatre, is a dance drama from Kerala. It was included into the **UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2008**. They are mainly enacted **inside the temples** and the theme is based on **Hindu mythology**.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Traditionally the **male role** is played by the **people from Chakyar caste** (a sub-caste among Hindus) and **female role** is played by the **women of the Ambalavasi Nambiar caste** play the female roles. The character "**Vidushaka**" explains in simple **Malayalam** the background of the story and gives a live image of the characters in the minds of the audience. All other **characters perform** using the **Sanskrit language**. **Mizhavu** is the major **musical instrument** used here.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.66) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is incorrect:** **Ramman** was included in the **UNESCO's List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2009**. It is a religious festival and ritual theatre of the **Garhwal region**, celebrated by the Hindu community in the Saloor-Dungra villages of the **Painkhanda Valley** in the **Chamoli district of Uttarakhand**.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** **Mudiyettu** is a folk dance and drama performed in the **State of Kerala**. It was included in UNESCO's **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2010**. It depicts the **mythological tale** of a **battle** between **Goddess Kali** and demon **Darika**.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Kalbelia** dance is performed by the **Kalbelia tribe of Rajasthan**. It was included in UNESCO's **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2010**. The dance movements **resemble** that of a **serpent**. The songs are based on mythology and it involves composing lyrics spontaneously and improvising songs during performance. **Musical instruments** which accompany performance include - **Poongi, Chang** and **Cymbals**.

Extra edge by OnlyIAS

- The **Ramman festival** is unique to Saloor-Dungra villages and is **not performed elsewhere** in the Himalayan region. An important aspect is the **singing of the Jagar**, a musical rendition of local legends.
- **Mudiyettu** is performed in the **village temples**, called **Bhagavati Kavus**, after the harvesting season usually between February and May. The performers do **heavy make-up** and wear gorgeous attire with conventional facial painting, tall headgear, etc. to give the **touch of the supernatural**. **Floor design of Goddess Kali** is drawn (known as **Kalam**) and is then **worshipped**.

Q.67) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Chhau** is a **tribal martial art dance performed** mainly in the States of **Odisha, Jharkhand** and **West Bengal**. It was included in UNESCO's **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2010**. The **theme** of the Chhau dance is based on **Hindu mythology**.

The dance is mainly performed during the spring festival and lasts for 13 days.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** There are **three subgenres** of this dance based on the place of their origin and development: **Purulia Chhau (West Bengal)**, **Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand)** and **Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha)**. **Masks** are worn by the dancers during performances **except for Mayurbhanj Chhau**. The dance is performed at night in an open space to traditional and folk melodies, played on the reed pipes "**Mohuri**" and "**Shehnai**."
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The masks of **Purulia Chhau** have been given a **Geographical Indication tag**, but the mask in **Saraikella Chhau** has **not** been given a Geographical Indication tag.

Reference:

Nitin Singhania, OnlyIAS June 2018 Current Affairs

Q.68) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Sankirtana is a ritual singing, drumming and dancing art form of **Manipur** which originated in the **15th century AD**. It was included in UNESCO's **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2013**. In a typical Sankirtana performance, two drummers and 10 singers-dancers perform in the hall of a domestic courtyard encircled by the devotees. Mainly **Cymbals and Drums** are used as musical instruments.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** This art form is performed to mark **religious occasions** and **various stages** in the **life of Manipuri Vaishnavites**. Practised mainly at temples, the performers here narrate the **life and deeds of Lord Krishna** through songs and dances.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.69) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The followers of **Varkari Sampradaya** are devotees of **Lord Vishnu**, in his manifestation as **Vithoba** and the worship is centered on **Vithoba's temple at Pandharpur in Maharashtra**. **Prominent figures** under this sect include **Jnaneshwar (1275-96)**, **Namdev (1270-**

1350), **Eknath (1533-99)** and **Tukaram (1598-1650)**.

The sect strictly **avoids alcohol and tobacco**. In their annual pilgrimage, **Vari**, the **Varkaris** carry the **padukas of the saints** in palkis from **Samadhi** to **Pandharpur**.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Brahma Sampradaya** is associated with **Lord Vishnu**, the **Para-Brahma or Universal Creator**. The founder was **Madhvacharya**. **Gaudiya Vaishnavism** promoted by **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu** is associated with **Brahma Sampradaya**. **ISKCON (International Society for Krishna Consciousness)** belongs to this sampradaya.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Pushti Marg Sampradaya** is a **Vaishnav sect** founded by **Vallabhacharya** around **1500AD**. Their philosophy is that the ultimate truth is one and only one **Brahm**. The devotion is based on **pure love for Lord Krishna**. All followers are expected to do **Seva** to their **personal idol of Krishna**.

Reference: Nitin Singhania

Q.70) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Nathpanthis** are also known as **Siddha Siddhanta**, and adhere to the teachings of **Gorakhnath and Matsyendranath** and worship the **Adinath** form of **Shiva**. They use the technique of **Hatha Yoga** to transform one's body into a state of awakened self's identity with absolute reality. The monks **never stay** in the same place for long and are a floating group of wanderers, and when they stop walking, they keep a **sacred fire called dhuni**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Dashanami Sanyasis** are associated with the **Advaita Vedanta tradition** and are the **disciples of Adi Shankaracharya**. They are also called "**Dash Nam Sanyasi**" as they are further divided into 10 groups.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Aghoris** are the devotees of **Shiva** manifested as **Bhairava** and are monists who seek **salvation** from the cycle of reincarnation through **sadhana in cremation grounds** and removal of bonds from their life which are sensual pleasure, anger, greed, obsession, fear and hatred. They indulge in **extreme, tamasic ritual practices**.

Reference: Nitin Singhania



Q.71) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option A is incorrect:** Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER), the percentage of students belonging to the eligible age group (18-23 years) enrolled in Higher Education, in 2019-20 is **27.1%** against 26.3% in 2018-19 and 24.3% in 2014-2015.
- **Option B is correct:** Gender Parity Index (GPI) in Higher Education in 2019-20 is **1.01** against 1.00 in 2018-19 indicating an improvement in the **relative access to higher education for females** of eligible age group compared to males.
- **Option C is incorrect:** Pupil Teacher Ratio in Higher Education in 2019-20 is **26**.
- **Option D is incorrect:** Total Enrolment in Higher Education stands at **3.85 crore in 2019-20** as compared to 3.74 crore in 2018-19, registering a growth of 11.36 lakh (**3.04%**). Total enrollment was 3.42 crore in 2014-15.

Extra Edge by OnlyIAS

Other highlights of the Survey

- **Total Enrolment** in Higher Education stands at **3.85 crore in 2019-20** as compared to 3.74 crore in 2018-19, registering a growth of 11.36 lakh (**3.04%**). Total enrollment was 3.42 crore in 2014-15.
- In 2019-20, There are **1043 Universities** (2%), **42343 Colleges** (77%) and **11779 Stand Alone Institutions** (21%) listed on AISHE web portal. 307 Universities are affiliating i.e. having Colleges.
- 3.38 crore Students enrolled in programmes at **under-graduate and postgraduate level**. Out of these, nearly 85% of the students (2.85 crore) were enrolled in the six major disciplines such as **Humanities, Science, Commerce, Engineering & Technology, Medical Science and IT & Computer**.

Reference:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=1725914>

Q.72) Ans: A

Exp:

Pangolins

- Pangolins, also known as **scaly anteaters**, are the **only mammals wholly-covered in scales** and they use those scales to protect themselves from predators in the wild. If under threat, a pangolin will immediately curl into a tight ball and will use their sharp-scaled tails to defend themselves. They are also toothless and **nocturnal**. They are widely trafficked mammals for medicinal purposes.
- Of the eight species found worldwide (four each in Asia and Africa), two are found in India: Indian Pangolin and Chinese Pangolin. **Both Indian Pangolin and Chinese Pangolin are listed in Schedule I of the Act.**
- **Habitat :**
 - Indian Pangolin is widely distributed in India, except the arid region, high Himalayas and the North-East. The species is also found in Bangladesh, Pakistan, Nepal and Sri Lanka.
 - Chinese Pangolin is found in the Himalayan foothills in Eastern Nepal, Bhutan, Northern India, North-East Bangladesh and through Southern China.
- **IUCN Status :**
 - Indian Pangolin: Endangered
 - Chinese Pangolin: Critically Endangered

https://www.wwfindia.org/news_facts/feature_stories/five_incredible_facts_about_pangolins/

Q.73) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct :** INS Sandhayak, was the first of its class indigenously designed and built Hydrographic Survey Ship of the Indian Navy. It was decommissioned recently after serving the nation for 40 years. Apart from Survey Missions, the ship has been an active participant in many significant operations such as **Op Pawan** – assisting the Indian Peace Keeping Force in Sri Lanka in 1987, **Op Sarong, Op Rainbow** - rendering humanitarian assistance post Tsunami of 2004 and participation in maiden joint INDO-US HADR Exercise '**Tiger-Triumph**'.
 - Hydrographic survey is the science of measurement and description of features which affect maritime



navigation, marine construction, dredging, offshore oil exploration/offshore oil drilling and related activities.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The design was finalised by Naval Headquarters and the construction of the ship was done at **Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE)** Kolkata'. GRSE is a shipbuilding company in India under the administrative control of the MoD, primarily catering to the shipbuilding requirements of the Indian Navy and the Indian Coast Guard.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1723980>

Q.74) Ans: C

Exp:

- The report titled, **"State of India's Environment 2021,"** released by the Centre for Science and Environment on the eve of the World Environment Day on 5th June.

Key findings of the report

- According to State of India's Environment Report 2021, **India's rank has dropped by two places to 117** as compared to 2020 ranking on 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- India **ranks below four South Asian countries — Bhutan, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh.**
- The overall SDG score of India is **61.9 out of 100**. Elaborating state-wise preparedness, the report said Jharkhand and Bihar are the least prepared to meet the SDGs by 2030. **States/UTs with the best overall score which are on the path to achieving the SDGs are Kerala, Himachal Pradesh and Chandigarh.**
- India's decline is primarily because major challenges like ending hunger and achieving food security (**SDG 2**), achieving gender equality (**SDG 5**) and building resilient infrastructure, promoting inclusive and sustainable industrialisation and fostering innovation (**SDG 9**) remain in the country.

Reference :

<https://www.financialexpress.com/economy/india-slips-two-spots-to-rank-117-on-17-sustainable->

development-goals-adopted-as-2030-agenda-report/2266142/

Q.75) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct: CHIME PROJECT IS a large stationary radio telescope in British Columbia, Canada.** CHIME comprises four massive cylindrical radio antennas, roughly the size and shape of snowboarding half-pipes, located at the Dominion Radio Astrophysical Observatory, operated by the National Research Council of Canada in British Columbia. The telescope receives radio signals each day from half of the sky as the Earth rotates.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Scientists with the Canadian Hydrogen Intensity Mapping Experiment (CHIME) Collaboration, who include researchers at the Pune-based **Tata Institute for Fundamental Research (TIFR)** and the **National Centre for Radio Astrophysics (NCRA)**, have assembled the largest collection of fast radio bursts (FRBs) in the **telescope's first FRB catalogue**. They have assembled the largest collection of fast radio bursts (FRBs) in the telescope's first FRB catalogue.
- **FRBs are oddly bright flashes of light**, registering in the radio band of the electromagnetic spectrum, which blaze for a few milliseconds before vanishing without a trace. These brief and mysterious beacons have been spotted in various and distant parts of the universe, as well as in our own galaxy. Their **origins are unknown and their appearance is highly unpredictable.**

Source:

<https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/chime-telescope-yields-unprecedented-results/article34782271.ece>

Q.76) Ans: D

Exp:

- **The Education Ministry** released the latest edition of the Performance Grading Index or PGI 2019-20 (third) which measures the **performance of states in school education**. The Education Ministry released the **first PGI in 2019 for the reference year 2017-18.**



- States are scored on a total of 1,000 points across 70 parameters, which are grouped under **five broad categories**:
 - **Access** (eg. enrolment ratio, transition rate and retention rate);
 - **Governance and management**;
 - **Infrastructure**;
 - **Equity** (difference in performance between scheduled caste students and general category students) and
 - **Learning outcomes** (average score in mathematics, science, languages and social science).
 - States are **graded and not ranked** to discourage the practice of one improving only at the cost of others. The PGI grading system has **10 levels**. Level 1 indicates top-notch performance and a score between 951 and 1,000 points. Level II, also known as Grade 1++, indicates a score between 901 and 950. Those with Grade 1+ (or Level III) have scored between 851 and 900. The lowest is Grade VII, and it means a score between 0 and 550 points.
 - In the PGI 2019-20, **Punjab recorded the highest score of almost 929 out of 1,000**. It topped the charts in terms of equity, infrastructure and governance, and shared the top spot in the domain of access with Kerala. Along with it **Chandigarh, Tamil Nadu, Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Kerala occupy the highest grade (Grade A++) for 2019-20**. The new Union Territory of **Ladakh was included separately for the first time in this edition, and had the lowest score of just 545**.
- Source:
<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=1724890>

Q.77) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**: With a vision to 'Cultivate one Million children in India as Neoteric Innovators', Atal Innovation Mission, an initiative of the National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog), Government Of India, is establishing Atal Tinkering Laboratories (ATLs) in schools across India.

- The objective of this scheme is to foster curiosity, creativity and imagination in young minds and inculcate skills such as design mind - set, computational thinking, adaptive learning, physical computing, rapid calculations, measurements etc.
- **Statement 2 is correct**: Key Features of ATL:
 - ATL is a work space where young minds can give shape to their ideas through hands-on do-it-yourself mode and learn innovation skills.
 - **Young children will get a chance to work with tools and equipment to understand the concepts of STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Math)**.
 - ATL would contain educational and learning 'do it yourself' kits and equipment on – science, electronics, robotics, open source microcontroller boards, sensors and 3D printers and computers.
 - ATL can conduct different activities ranging from regional and national level competitions, exhibitions, workshops on problem solving, designing and fabrication of products, lecture series etc. at periodic intervals.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect**: AIM will provide grant-in-aid of Rs. 20 Lakh to each school that includes a one-time establishment cost of Rs. 10 lakh and operational expenses of Rs. 10 lakh for a maximum period of 5 years to each ATL. Atal Tinkering Laboratories are set up Where Schools (minimum Grade VI – X) are managed by Government, local body or private trusts/society to set up ATL.

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=1687635>

Q.78) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct**: The Arctic is a polar region located at the northernmost part of Earth. The Arctic consists of the Arctic Ocean, adjacent seas, and parts of Alaska (United States), Canada, Finland, Greenland (Denmark), Iceland, Norway, Russia, and

Sweden. Land within the Arctic region has seasonally varying snow and ice cover.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** India's engagement with the Arctic began in 1920 when it signed the Svalbard Treaty in Paris. In 2007, India launched its first scientific expedition to the Arctic. In 2008, India had set up a research station 'Himadri' in the international Arctic research base at Ny-Ålesund in Spitsbergen, Svalbard, Norway. Himadri is manned for about 180 days a year. IndArc, the country's first multi-sensor moored observatory was deployed in Kongsfjorden in 2014. In 2016, India's northernmost atmospheric laboratory was established at Gruebadet.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Arctic Council is an intergovernmental forum established by the eight Arctic States through the Ottawa Declaration of 1996. It discusses and addresses issues concerning the Arctic region. Members - Canada, Denmark, Norway, Russia, USA, Finland, Sweden and Iceland.
 - Besides these, 6 organisations representing the indigenous people of the Arctic region are granted the status of permanent participants.
 - All decision-making happens through consensus between the eight members, and in consultation with the permanent participants.

<https://thediplomat.com/2021/01/india-releases-draft-arctic-policy/>

Q.79) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Open Skies Treaty was signed in 1992 and entered into force on January 1, 2002. Which permits each state-party to conduct short-notice, unarmed, reconnaissance flights over the others' entire territories to collect data on military forces and activities. It aim to build confidence among members through mutual openness thus reducing the chances of accidental war.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Under the treaty, a member state can spy on any part of the host nation, with the latter's consent. A country can undertake aerial imaging over the host state after

giving notice 72 hours before and sharing its exact flight path 24 hours before. The information gathered such as troop movements, military exercises and missile deployments has to be shared with all member states. Only approved imaging equipment is permitted on the surveillance flights and officials from the host state can also stay on board throughout the planned journey.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Currently, 34 states are party to the treaty while a 35th, Kyrgyzstan, has signed but not ratified it. India is not a member of this treaty. The Open Skies Consultative Commission (OSCC), composed of representatives of all states-parties, is responsible for the implementation of the Open Skies Treaty.

<https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/what-russias-exit-means-for-the-open-skies-treaty-7150167>

Q.80) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** A fourth edition of the One Planet Summit dedicated to biodiversity aiming to raise the level of ambition of the international community on nature protection, the event focused on four themes:
 1. Protection of terrestrial and marine ecosystems
 2. Promotion of agroecology
 3. Finance for biodiversity
 4. Protecting forests, species and human health
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Paris, France organized, in cooperation with the United Nations and the World Bank, a fourth edition of the One Planet Summit dedicated to biodiversity. This Summit brought together heads of state and government, leaders of international organizations, business leaders and civil society and was an opportunity to coordinate actions to take concrete action to preserve and restore ecosystems and to initiate profound changes in our economy. Theme of Summit Let's act together for nature.



Extra Edge by Only Ias

Key Outcome of the summit

- At least 50 countries committed to protecting 30% of the planet, including land and sea, to halt species extinction and address climate change issues.
- France has announced the High Ambition Coalition for Nature and People, which was launched in 2019 by Costa Rica, France and Britain to set a target of protecting at least 30% of the planet by 2030, has now been joined by 50 countries.
- The summit also launched a program called PREZODE which the French President presented as an unprecedented international initiative to prevent the emergence of zoonotic diseases and pandemics.

https://wwf.panda.org/wwf_news/?1217416/One-Planet-Summit-Leaders-take-action-for-human-and-planetary-health-but-step-change-still-urgently-needed

<https://onu.delegfrance.org/one-planet-summit>

Q.81) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** A star campaigner is a celebrity vote seeker in an election for a party. This person can be a politician or even a film star. There is no law governing who can or cannot be made a star campaigner. They are nominated by the concerned political parties, specifying their constituencies and the duration of their status. **A 'recognised' party declared as such by the Election Commission - can nominate a maximum of 40 star campaigners.** An unrecognised political party can nominate a maximum of 20 star campaigners.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Expenditure incurred on electioneering by the star campaigner is **not added to a candidate's poll expenditure** giving him/her more leeway. According to the Representation of People's Act, these expenses will be borne by the political parties. For an individual candidate to get relief from campaign expenditure, the star campaigner has to limit himself to general campaigning for

the party. If she/he shares the stage with a candidate, the entire campaign cost except expenditure incurred on travelling will be added to the candidate's election expenses. This applies even if the star campaigner seeks to vote for the candidate taking his or her name. If more than one candidate shares the stage with the star campaigner, the expenditure incurred on the rally will be shared equally by the contestants. If the candidates are not present but their posters or photographs have been displayed in their constituencies where a star campaigner holds a poll rally, the entire expense will be added to the election expenses of the contestants.

Source: <https://www.indiatoday.in/india/story/who-is-a-star-campaigner-why-is-this-status-significant-in-elections-1737308-2020-11-02>

Q.82) Ans: B

Exp:

K-shaped recovery

- A K-shaped recovery occurs when, following a recession, different parts of the economy recover at different rates, times, or magnitudes.
- It describes the path of different disaggregated economic variables, such as income across different segments of society or employment in different industries, relative to one another.
- In India, households at the top of the pyramid are likely to have seen their incomes largely protected, and savings rates forced up during the lockdown.
- Meanwhile, households at the bottom are likely to have witnessed permanent hits to jobs and incomes.
- COVID has triggered an effective income transfer from the poor to the rich, this will be demand-impeding because the poor have a higher marginal propensity to consume (i.e) they tend to spend (instead of saving) a much higher proportion of their income.

Other possible recoveries



- V-Shaped
 - A V-shaped recovery is the quickest and one of the most ideal. In this type of recovery, the economy falls quickly but also recovers quickly—it doesn't remain stagnant for very long.
- U-Shaped
 - A U-shaped recovery is a bit more drawn out than a V-shaped one. the economy falls quickly but also recovers quickly
- W-Shaped
 - A W-shaped recovery, also known as a double-dip recession, involves a short recovery followed by another decline before the economy goes into a more long-term recovery.
- L-Shaped
 - An L-shaped recovery is the least optimistic. With this type of recovery before improving in a meaningful way.

<https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-ideas-what-is-a-k-shaped-economic-recovery-and-what-are-its-implications-7141416/>
<https://www.thebalance.com/k-shaped-recovery-5120738>

Q.83) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** RBI has operationalised **Payments Infrastructure Development Fund (PIDF) Scheme** to boost digital payments. Its objective is to develop payment acceptance infrastructure in tier-3 to tier-6 cities (centres), with a special focus on the north-eastern states of the country. It is to increase the number of acceptance devices multi-fold in the country. The Scheme is expected to benefit the acquiring banks / non-banks and merchants by lowering overall acceptance infrastructure cost.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Duration of schemes is for three years from January 01, 2021, extendable by two further years, if necessary. Increasing payments acceptance infrastructure by adding 30 lakh touch points – 10 lakh physical and 20 lakh digital payment acceptance devices every year. **Payments Infrastructure Development Fund**

(PIDF) Scheme shall be governed by an ex-officio Advisory Council (AC). The PIDF presently has a corpus of Rs. 345 crore, with Rs. 250 crore contributed by the RBI and Rs. 95 crore by the major authorised card networks in the country. The authorised card networks shall contribute in all Rs. 100 crore.

https://rbidocs.rbi.org.in/rdocs/notification/PDFs/NO_T81766182E7EBA04921A35B2EF835F4CA1E.PDF

Q.84) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) for FY 2019-25 is a first-of-its-kind, whole-of-government exercise to provide world-class infrastructure to citizens and improve their quality of life. It aims to improve project preparation and attract investments into infrastructure. Growing urbanisation, increasing working-age population, shift to a services-based economy and climate change are some of the factors that will require a further boost to India's infrastructure sector and amplify the need for the National Infrastructure Pipeline.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The national infrastructure pipeline aims to boost the economy to create more employment opportunities in different sectors, provide better infrastructure for all sectors, enhance ease of living for its citizens and make growth more inclusive. It was first announced by the Prime Minister of India Narendra Modi during his 2019 Independence Day speech. In order to sustain its growth rate and increase its competitiveness, India aims to focus more on well-developed infrastructure that enhances the level of economic activity. To achieve the GDP of \$5 trillion by 2024-25, India needs to spend about \$1.4 trillion (Rs. 100 lakh crore) over these years on infrastructure.

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=1685949>

Q.85) Ans: C



Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO) is the international body that brings together the world's securities regulators and is recognized as the global standard setter for the securities sector. IOSCO develops, implements and promotes adherence to internationally recognized standards for securities regulation. **It works intensively with the G20 and the Financial Stability Board (FSB) on the global regulatory reform agenda.** The IOSCO is the international organization that brings together the world's securities regulators, covering more than 95% of the world's securities markets, and is the global standard setter for the securities sector. The IOSCO Objectives and Principles of Securities Regulation have been endorsed by FSB as one of the key standards for sound financial systems.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) has become an Associate Member of the International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO). The membership of IOSCO would provide IFSCA the platform to exchange information at the global level and regional level on areas of common interests. Further, the IOSCO platform would enable IFSCA to learn from the experiences and best practices of the regulators of other well established financial centres. The IOSCO's membership is a significant milestone in connecting IFSCA with the regulators of securities markets globally and would contribute immensely towards the development and regulation of the financial products, financial services and financial institutions at the Gujarat International Finance Tec-City International Financial Services Centre.

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseDetail.aspx?PRID=1685949>

Q.86) Ans: A

Exp:

About Global Forest Goals Report

- It is the first assessment of where the world stands in terms of meeting the UN Strategic Plan for Forests 2030. It was created by the **United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA) and its United**

Nations Forum on Forests Secretariat (UNFFS).

- It is **based on** global quantitative and biophysical evidence, primarily from the **Food and Agriculture Organization's Global Forest Resources Assessment (FRA) 2020.**
- It is **based on 52 voluntary national reports and 19 voluntary national contributions** that constitute 75% of the world's forests.

UN Strategic Plan for Forests 2017-2030

- At a special session of the UN Forum on Forests in 2017, the first-ever UN Strategic Plan for Forests was adopted.
- The strategy includes six Global Forest Goals and 26 related targets that must be met by 2030.
- Both of them are self-evident and universally applicable.
- It also contains a target of increasing forest area by 3% globally by 2030.
- This represents a 120 million hectare rise, or more than twice the size of France.

Source : <https://www.un.org/esa/forests/wp-content/uploads/2021/04/Global-Forest-Goals-Report-2021.pdf>

Q.87) Ans: D

Exp:

- A strait is a thin channel of waterways i.e. narrow passage of water that connects two seas or two other large areas of water and are used by commercial shipping to travel from one sea or exclusive economic zone to another and they are of immense strategic and commercial importance.
- The important straits across the world are as follows:

Strait	Connects	
	Location	
• Malacca Strait	Andaman Sea &	Indonesia-
• South China Sea		Malaysia
• Palk Strait	Palk Bay & Bay of	
• Bengal	India- Sri Lanka	
• Sunda Strait	Java Sea & Indian	
• Ocean	Java- Sumatra	

- Yucatan Strait and Caribbean Sea Gulf of Mexico Mexico- Cuba
- Otranto Strait Adriatic Sea & Ionian Sea Italy- Albania
- **Bab-el-Mandeb of Aden** **Red Sea & Gulf of Aden** Yemen- Djibouti, Eritrea
- **Cook Strait** **Tasman Sea and South Pacific Ocean** New Zealand
- Mozambique Strait Indian Ocean Mozambique- Madagascar
- Bass Strait Tasman Sea & South Sea Australia- Tasmania
- **Bosphorus Strait** **Black Sea and Marmara Sea** Istanbul
- Kerch Strait Black Sea and the Sea of Azov Crimea- Russia
- Korea Strait East China Sea and Sea of Japan Korea- Japan
- Formosa Strait South China Sea & East China Sea China- Taiwan
- Makassar Strait Java Sea & Celebes Sea Borneo- Indonesia
- **Magellan strait** **Pacific and South Atlantic Ocean** Chiles
- Gibraltar Strait Mediterranean Sea & Atlantic Ocean Spain- Morocco
- **Dardanelles Strait and Aegean Sea** **Marmara Sea** Turkey
- Denmark Strait North Atlantic and Arctic Ocean Greenland- Iceland
- Hormuz Strait Gulf of Persia & Gulf of Oman Oman- Iran

accelerate the global transition to a **zero-carbon economy**.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Race to zero campaign, Race to resilience are initiatives of Climate Breakthroughs Summit. The Race to Zero Breakthroughs have been drawn from the Climate Action Pathways. Race to Zero is the UN-backed global campaign rallying non-state actors – including companies, cities, regions, financial and educational institutions – to **take rigorous and immediate action** to halve global emissions by 2030 and deliver a healthier, fairer, zero-carbon world in time.

source: <https://unfccc.int/news/climate-breakthroughs-summit-highlights-crucial-momentum-for-net-zero-emissions>

Q.89) Ans: B

Exp:

The Caspian Sea is the world's largest water body that is enclosed or bordered by land on all sides. This massive lake is located between Asia and Europe.



- **Countries surrounded by Caspian sea:** Five countries in Asia and Europe share the Caspian Sea's coastline. It is bordered to the north and east by **Kazakhstan** and from north to the west by **Russia**. **Azerbaijan** borders the sea to the southwest, while **Iran** is in the south. **Turkmenistan** lies along the southern portion of the eastern coast.
- Besides the five countries bordering the sea, the Caspian Sea drains Armenia, the eastern part of Georgia, the western portion of

Q.88) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Climate Breakthroughs Summit — a collaboration between the World Economic Forum, Mission Possible Partnership, the United Nations Climate Champions, and the United Kingdom Climate Change Conference (COP26) Presidency. It aims to demonstrate the need for systemic change to



Uzbekistan, and the north-eastern part of Turkey.

- **Climate of caspian sea:** The Caspian Sea region is one of the world's dry regions. The large water body crosses more than one climate region. The different climate regions coincide with the climate of the various countries sharing the sea's coastline. The extreme north, which falls within Kazakhstan and Russia experiences a cold and dry temperate continental climate. The sea's southern part, shared by Azerbaijan, Turkmenistan, and Iran is much warmer.

The surface temperature over the Caspian Sea varies with the regions.

- **Economy of Caspian sea :** The Caspian Sea is a significant crude oil supplier. It produces about 1.5 million barrels of crude oil and natural gas per day, accounting for about 1.9% of the world's total.

<https://www.google.com/amp/s/www.worldatlas.com/amp/lakes/caspian-sea.html>

- Upper divergence above the sea level system.

Extra Edge by Only Ias

Different terminology is used for this weather phenomenon depending on the location:

- In the Caribbean Sea, the Gulf of Mexico, the North Atlantic Ocean and the eastern and central North Pacific Ocean, it is called "**hurricane**"
- In the western North Pacific, it is called "**typhoon**"
- In the Bay of Bengal and Arabian Sea, it is called "**cyclone**"
- In western South Pacific and southeast Indian Ocean, it is called "**severe tropical cyclone**"
- In the southwest Indian Ocean, it is called "**tropical cyclone**"

Q.90) Ans: A

Exp:

Tropical Cyclone

- A tropical cyclone is a rapid rotating storm originating over tropical oceans from where it draws the energy to develop.
- It has a low pressure centre and clouds spiraling towards the eyewall surrounding the "eye", the central part of the system where the weather is normally calm and free of clouds. Its diameter is typically around 200 to 500 km, but can reach 1000 km.
- A tropical cyclone brings very violent winds, torrential rain, high waves and, in some cases, very destructive storm surges and coastal flooding. The winds blow counterclockwise in the Northern Hemisphere and clockwise in the Southern Hemisphere.

The conditions favourable for the formation and intensification of tropical storms are:

- Large sea surface with temperature higher than 27° C;
- Presence of the Coriolis force;
- Small variations in the vertical wind speed;
- A pre-existing weak low-pressure area or low-level-cyclonic circulation;

Q.91) Ans: D

Exp:

Tropical cyclones

- Tropical cyclones are violent storms that originate over oceans in tropical areas and move over to the coastal areas bringing about large scale destruction caused by violent winds, very heavy rainfall and storm surges.

Recent Tropical Cyclones in various part of world:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Cyclone Tauktae : **It was the first cyclonic storm that emerged from the Arabian Sea. It hit southern Gujarat and was classified as a Very Severe Cyclonic Storm (VSCS).**
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** Hurricane Iota was a devastating late-season Category 4 Atlantic hurricane which caused severe damage to areas of Central America.
- **Pair 3 is incorrect:** Typhoon Surigae, known in the Philippines as Typhoon Bising, was the strongest Northern Hemisphere tropical cyclone and one of the most intense tropical cyclones on record.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** Cyclone Marcus was a very powerful tropical cyclone that struck Australia's Northern Territory and the Kimberley region of Western Australia.

Source : NCERT FUNDAMENTALS OF PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY page no :75,76



Q.92) Ans: B

Exp:

The factors which affect the distribution of temperature of ocean water are :

- **Latitude** : The temperature of surface water decreases from the equator towards the poles because the amount of insolation decreases poleward.
- **Unequal distribution of land and water** : The oceans in the northern hemisphere receive more heat due to their contact with larger extent of land than the oceans in the southern hemisphere.
- **Prevailing wind** : The winds blowing from the land towards the oceans drive warm surface water away from the coast resulting in the upwelling of cold water from below. It results into the longitudinal variation in the temperature. Contrary to this, the onshore winds pile up warm water near the coast and this raises the temperature.
- **Ocean currents** : Warm ocean currents raise the temperature in cold areas while the cold currents decrease the temperature in warm ocean areas. The Gulf stream (warm current) raises the temperature near the eastern coast of North America and the West Coast of Europe while the Labrador current (cold current) lowers the temperature near the north-east coast of North America.

All these factors influence the temperature of the ocean currents locally. The enclosed seas in the low latitudes record relatively higher temperature than the open seas; whereas the enclosed seas in the high latitudes have lower temperature than the open seas. Longitude does not affect the distribution of ocean current water.

Source : NCERT FUNDAMENTALS OF PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY page no :111

Q.93) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** : The Index for Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) evaluates progress of states and Union Territories (UTs) on various parameters including health, education, gender, economic

growth, institutions, climate change and environment. First launched in December 2018, the index has become the primary tool for monitoring progress on the SDGs in India. It has also fostered competition among the states and UTs by ranking them on the global goals.

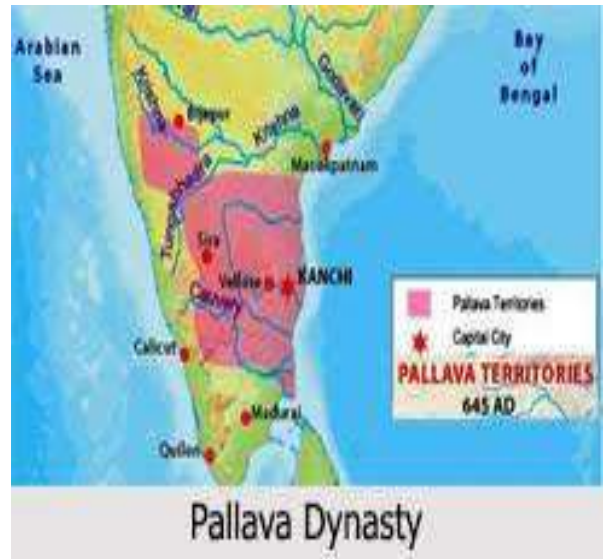
- **Statement 2 is Correct:** The SDG India Index 2020–21 incorporate 16 out of 17 SDGs. The Index scores range between 0–100, higher the score of a State/UT, the greater the distance to target achieved. States and UTs are classified in four categories based on their SDG India Index score — aspirant: 0–49; performer: 50–64; front-runner: 65–99, achiever: 100. Currently, there are no states in the aspirant and achiever category
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The top-five and bottom-five States in SDG India Index 2020–21:

<u>Top five states</u>	<u>Bottom five states</u>
1. Kerala	1. Chattisgarh, Nagaland, Odisha
2. Himachal Pradesh, Tamilnadu	2. Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Rajasthan, Uttarpradesh
3. Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Karnataka, Uttarakhand	3. Assam
4. Sikkim	4. Jharkhand
5. Maharashtra	5. Bihar

Extra Edge by Only Ias

Sustainable Development Goals

- The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), also known as the Global Goals, were adopted by the United Nations in 2015 as a universal call to action to end poverty, protect the planet, and ensure that by 2030 all people enjoy peace and prosperity.
- The 17 SDGs are integrated—they recognize that action in one area will affect outcomes in others, and that development must balance social, economic and environmental sustainability.



- The exact origin of the Pallava dynasty is not known to historians.
- The capital was **Kanchipuram**.
- It was spreaded in **Andhrapradesh region**.
- Most of the rulers of Pallava dynasty practised hindu religion however **Simhavarman I practised Buddhism**.
- Pallava dynasty ruled **from 3th century CE to 9th century CE in different phases of peak and low**. Satvahanas ruled from 2nd century BCE to 3rd century CE in Maharashtra region. Pallava ruler **Narsimhavarman defeated and killed Chalukya king Pulakesin 2 and captured its capital Vatapi hence called 'vatapikonda'**.
- Pallava dynasty had contributed immensely in **temple building**,
The Dravidian style of temple architecture began with the Pallava rule.
- Shore temple** at mahabalipuram by king **Rajsimha**.
- Kailashnath temple** at kanchipuram by king **Rajsimha**.
- Vaikuntha Perumal temple** at kanchipuram by king **Nandivarman**.

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1723952>

Q.94) Ans: D

Exp:

Both statements are incorrect

- Pallava Dynasty :

Reference : Tamilnadu class 11 state board page number : 122 , 123 , 124 ,128.

Q.95) Ans: C

Exp:

Both the statements are correct :

- Under the **3rd Bodo Peace accord 2020**, a Bodoland Territorial Region was formed with enhanced executive and legislative powers.



- The region is administered by an elected body known as the **Bodoland Territorial Council (BTC)** which was established according to the Memorandum of Settlement of 2003.
- Manas National Park** is spreaded over Chirang and Baksa district in the region.

Reference :

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bodoland_Territorial_Region#Districts

Q.96) Ans: C

Exp:

About the CBI

- CBI is the **premier investigating agency in India**. CBI works under the superintendence of the **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and pensions**.
- CBI derives the power of investigation from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.
- The Institution of CVC exercises superintendence over CBI under the **prevention of corruption act, 1988**.
- CBI director has been provided security of **two year tenure** in CBI by the CVC Act, 2003.
- Lokpal Act 2014**, has provided committee for appointment of CBI director which includes :
 - Prime Minister : Chairperson.
 - Leader of opposition or Leader of the single largest opposition party.
 - Chief Justice Of India / supreme court judge recommended by chief justice.

- CBI can exercise its suo-motu investigations powers only in Union Territories.

Reference :

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Central_Bureau_of_Investigation

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/subodh-kumar-jaiswal-appointed-cbi-director/article34644724.ece>

Q.97) Ans: C

Exp:

- As per the data provided by the Economic Survey 2020-21, India adopted a four pillar policy response strategy for dealing with shocks posed by the COVID-19. These measures are clubbed under four heads:
 - Containment measures** that comprise 21 days of nationwide lockdown, school closures, travel bans, social distancing, and containment zones classification.
 - Fiscal Policy measures:** These involved measures like Creation of Emergency Health Fund, PM Garib Kalyan Yojana, Garib Kalyan Rojgar Yojana, Stimulus package announced by the Government under the three Atma Nirbhar Packages.
 - Monetary measures** like the lowering of repo and the reverse repo rate, Targeted Long Term Repo Operations, Enhanced Ways and Means Advances borrowing limits, Relaxation of the withdrawal rules under the Consolidated Sinking Funds.
 - Structural Reforms:** Enactment of Farm laws i.e., Farmers' Produce Trade and Commerce (Promotion and Facilitation) Act, 2020; Farmers (Empowerment and Protection) Agreement of Price Assurance and Farm Services Act, 2020; Essential Commodities (Amendment) Act, 2020. New definition for the MSMEs, formulation of the four labor codes namely Wage code, Industrial relations code, code on occupational safety, health and working conditions, Social security code. In the defense sector, the increase in the FDI limit to 74% from the current 49% under the automatic route.



- Hence, the relaxation of withdrawals under the Consolidated Sinking Fund forms a part of the monetary reforms and not the structural reforms.

Source: Economic survey 2020-2021

Q.98) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** National Startup Advisory Council is chaired by the Union Minister of Commerce and Industry. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) had constituted the National Startup Advisory Council to advise the Government on measures needed to build a strong ecosystem for nurturing innovation and startups in the country to drive sustainable economic growth and generate large scale employment opportunities. Nominees of the concerned departments/Ministries and organizations not below the rank of Joint Secretary form the ex-officio members of this Council. Besides the ex-officio members, the council has a number of non-official members, representing various stakeholders such as founders of successful startups, veterans who have grown and scaled companies in India, etc.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **SAHAKAR MITRA Scheme** on Internship Program (SIP) is an arrangement where **NCDC (National Cooperative Development Cooperation)**, a statutory body under the **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare** will provide short term (not exceeding four months) opportunity to young professionals to acquire learning experience by applying skills and knowledge in organizational context to facilitate professional development. The programme aims at providing an opportunity to professional graduates to get experience in areas of functioning of NCDC and related aspects of cooperatives.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseframePage.aspx?PRID=1712081#:~:text=Department%20for%20Promotion%20of%20Industry,and%20generate%20large%20scale%20employment> ; https://ncdc.in/documents/whats-new/2616120620Sahakar_Mitra_English.pdf

Q.99) Ans: B

Exp:

- Option B is correct:
- **Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India (EDII)**, an autonomous and not-for-profit institute, set up in 1983, is sponsored by apex financial institutions - the IDBI Bank Ltd., IFCI Ltd., ICICI Bank Ltd. and the State Bank of India (SBI). It is not an initiative of NITI Aayog.
- The **Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP)** is a Government of India initiative by **NITI Aayog** to promote and support aspiring as well as established women entrepreneurs in India, assist and handhold them in their journey from starting up to scaling up and expanding their ventures.
- The **India Innovation Index** is released by **NITI Aayog** and the **Institute for Competitiveness** every year. The index attempts to create an extensive framework for the continuous evaluation of the innovation environment in all States and Union Territories; it ranks them on the basis of their scores. NITI Aayog released the second edition on 20 January 2021.
- The first-ever **Export Preparedness Index (EPI)** was launched in August 2020 and developed by **NITI Aayog** in partnership with the **Institute for Competitiveness**. EPI ranks all States and Union Territories based on their export readiness and performance. EPI 2020 is based on four pillars: export policy; business environment; export infrastructure; and export performance. It can be used by States and UTs to benchmark their performance against their peers and analyze the potential challenges to develop better policy mechanisms to foster export-led growth at the subnational level.

Source: <https://www.niti.gov.in/> ; https://www.ediindia.org/the_institute

Q.100) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The President can remove the chairman or any other member of UPSC from office under the following circumstances:
 - If he is adjudged an insolvent



- If he engages, during his term of office, in any paid employment outside the duties of his office
- If he is in the opinion of the President, unfit to continue in office by reason of infirmity of mind or body.

In addition to these, the President can also remove the chairman or any other member of UPSC for misbehaviour. However, in this case the President has to refer the matter to the Supreme Court for an enquiry. Under the provisions of the Constitution, the advice tendered by the Supreme Court in this regard is binding on the President.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Supreme Court has held that if the Government fails to consult UPSC, the aggrieved public servant has no remedy in a court. Any irregularity in consultation with the UPSC or acting without the consultation will not invalidate the decision of the Government. Thus the provision is discretionary and not mandatory.